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Methods of transmitting neural activity

Abstract

Devices, methods and systems for transmitting signals through a device located in a blood vessel of an animal, for stimulating and/or sensing activity of media proximal to the device, wherein the media includes tissue and/or fluid.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/528,484, filed Dec. 4, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/943,883 filed Jul. 30, 2020, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/955,412 filed Apr. 17, 2018, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,729,530, which claims the benefit of priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/486,851 filed Apr. 18, 2017, which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety for all purposes. U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/955,412 is also a continuation-in-part of International Patent Application No. PCT/US2016/057768 filed Oct. 19, 2016, now published as WO2017/070252, which is a non-provisional application of Australian Provisional Application 2015904302 filed Oct. 20, 2015, of Australian Provisional Application 2015905045 filed Dec. 4, 2015, and of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/379,625 filed Aug. 25, 2016, the contents of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety for all purposes.

TECHNICAL FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention relates to a medical device for implantation into a blood vessel of an animal.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Any discussion of documents, devices, acts, or knowledge in this specification is included to explain the context of the invention. It should not be taken as an admission that any of the material forms a part of the prior art base or the common general knowledge in the relevant art in Australia or elsewhere on or before the priority date of the disclosure and broad statements herein.

(3) In the United States alone, nearly two million people suffer from various neuromuscular disorders where control of limbs is severely impaired. In many of these patients, however, the portion of the brain responsible for movement remains intact, and it is disease and trauma to the spinal cord, nerves, and muscles that limit mobility, function, and independence. For these people,

the ability to restore lost control at even a rudimentary level could lead to a greatly improved quality of life.

(4) At present, there are two primary options for restoring function. One option is to increase the capabilities of the remaining pathways, substituting paralyzed or amputated muscles with those under voluntary control. While this method has been highly successful for amputees by re-innervating forearm nerves into abdominal muscles which control a bionic arm, the restored function greatly depends on the site of damage or condition, with people paralyzed by brainstem or high cervical injuries only able to achieve minor functional improvement. A second option is to provide the brain with a new communication and control channel to convey messages to the external world. Currently, these brain-controlled interfaces (BCIs) measure electroencephalographic or other electrophysiological activity via surgically implanted epidural, subdural, and intracortical electrodes. While cortical measurements performed with electrodes placed on the scalp enable non-invasive neuronal measurements, they require daily application and are prone to noise and movement-related artifacts. Penetrating and non-penetrating intracranial electrodes, implanted after a craniotomy directly onto the surface of a cortical area, have much better signal-to-noise ratios (relative to scalp electrodes) and have been shown to enable rudimentary prosthetic hand operation. These methods, however, require invasive surgery and carry a relatively high risk of complication, which can involve infections and bleeding. Furthermore, craniotomies are limited in access to the central nervous system, with many motor and sensory cortex areas hidden and inaccessible within cortical folds. These approaches are restricted in position and, cannot be relocated once implanted and are subject to signal deterioration due to glial scar formation surrounding penetrating electrodes.

(5) Thus, there remains a need to record and stimulate from cortical tissue in a method which is minimally invasive whilst also ensuring longevity and efficacy of recorded and induced signals.

(6) By using blood vessels as a conduit to the brain, the risks associated with craniotomies, and the invasive creation of a burr hole in the skull of the patient is removed whilst also removing current noise and movement related artifacts observed with non-invasive scalp electrodes. Despite the minimally invasive benefits provided by these types of procedures, it is preferable that thrombus formation caused by the blockage of blood flow through a vessel is prevented. It is also preferable that the electrical energy delivered to the electrodes be as efficient as possible, which will reduce the burden placed on the electrical circuitry. Optimization of wireless telemetry aimed to send power and data directly through the body to the implanted device, will enhance device functionality and negate the risk of infection caused through lead wires creating a direct passage between the vessel and the external environment. The ability to implant coils inside blood vessels will similarly reduce surgical risks associated with perforated vasculature.

(7) Thus, there remains a need to provide improved intravascular electrodes, telemetry circuitry and implantation positions that are capable of more efficiently transmitting and receiving electrical energy between vessels and external circuitry, while minimizing the occlusion of blood flow.

(8) It is generally desirable to overcome or ameliorate one or more of the above mentioned difficulties, or at least provide a useful alternative.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(9) According to the present invention, there is provided a medical device for implantation into a blood vessel of an animal, including: (a) a stent movable between a collapsed condition of use for insertion into said vessel and an expanded condition of use for resiliently bearing against a wall of said vessel; (b) one or more electrodes coupled to the stent for stimulating and/or sensing activity of media proximal to the device, wherein the media includes tissue and/or fluid. The term stent is meant to include any support structure that maintains, carries, supports or incorporates the one or more electrodes within the tissue and/or fluid. The term stent can include conventionally designed medical stents, alternatively, the term stent can include any mechanical framework or scaffolding that positions electrode elements within a body lumen, such as a vessel, and facilitates electrical

coupling of the electrode element(s) to a lead or other conductive structure. In certain variations, portions of the support structure itself can function as electrodes.

(10) According to the present invention, there is also provided a method of recording of neural information or stimulation of neurons from the superior sagittal sinus or branching cortical veins of a patient using the above described device, including the steps of: (a) implanting the device in either the superior sagittal sinus or branching cortical veins; (b) receiving activity; and (c) generating data representing said activity; and (d) transmitting said data to a control unit.

(11) According to the present invention, there is also provided a method of for stimulation and recording neural information or stimulation of neurons from the visual cortex of a patient using the above-described device, including the steps of: (a) implanting the device in a vessel in the visual cortex of the patient; and (b) recording neural information associated with the vessel or stimulating neurons in accordance with received stimulation data.

(12) According to the present invention, there is also provided a system for controlling use of apparatus coupled to an animal or human, including: (a) the above-described device, said device being adapted for placement within a vessel of an animal or human to stimulate and/or sense the activity of media proximal to the device; (b) a control unit adapted for communication with the device; (c) apparatus coupleable to the animal or human, said apparatus adapted for in communication with the control unit, wherein the control unit is adapted to perform the steps of: (i) receiving data from the device representing activity of media proximal to the device; (ii) generating control signals for the apparatus; and (iii) sending said control signals to said apparatus.

(13) According to the present invention, there is also provided a control unit for controlling operation of apparatus coupled to an animal or a human, said control unit being adapted to perform the steps of: (a) receiving data from the above-described device, said data representing activity of media proximal to a vessel within which the device is placed; (b) generating control signals for controlling operation of the apparatus; and (c) sending said control signals to the apparatus.

(14) The present disclosure further includes a medical device for use within a tubular body having a lumen, the medical device comprising: a frame structure forming a plurality of struts, where the frame structure is moveable between a reduce profile and an expanded profile in which a diameter of the frame structure increases; where at least one of the plurality of struts forming the frame structure comprises an electrically conductive material on a support material, the electrically conductive material extending along at least a portion of the strut and being covered with a non-conductive material; at least one electrode formed by an opening in the non-conductive material on the portion of the strut; and a lead located at an end of the frame structure and configured to be in electrical communication with the electrically conductive portion, the lead extending from the frame structure.

(15) The medical device can further include a connector block configured to electrically couple the medical device to an external device, where the lead extends from the frame structure to the connector block.

(16) In another variation, the present disclosure includes a method of recording of neural information or stimulation of neurons a patient the method comprising: receiving a signal representative of neural activity from a device positioned in a vessel of the patient; generating data representing said activity using the signal; and transmitting said data to a control unit; generating a control signal from the control unit; and transmitting the control signal to an apparatus coupled to the patient.

(17) The present disclosure also includes a system for controlling an apparatus coupled to an animal or human. In one example, the system comprises a device adapted for placement within a vessel of the animal or human to stimulate and/or sense the activity of media proximal to the device; a control unit adapted for communication with the device, wherein the control unit is adapted to: (i) receive data from the device representing activity of media proximal to the device; (ii) generate a control signal; and (iii) transmit the control signal to said apparatus.

(18) The system can include an apparatus selected from or more of the following: an exoskeleton; a prosthetic limb; a wheelchair; a computer; and/or an electrical or electro-mechanical device.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) Variations of the present invention are hereafter described, by way of non-limiting example only, with reference to the accompanying drawing. Like reference numerals in the drawings indicate identical or functionally similar features/elements throughout.
- (2) FIG. 1 is a diagrammatic illustration of a system for controlling use of apparatus coupled to an animal or a human.
- (3) FIG. 2A is a diagrammatic illustration showing parts of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (4) FIG. 2B is a diagrammatic illustration showing of an additional variation of the system comprising two or more stents.
- (5) FIG. 3 is a diagrammatic illustration showing parts of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (6) FIG. 4 is a diagrammatic illustration of a control unit of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (7) FIG. 5A is a diagrammatic illustration of a medical device of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (8) FIG. 5B is a cross-section view through the line A-A of the device shown in FIG. 5a.
- (9) FIG. 5C is a schematic diagram of a wireless chip.
- (10) FIG. 5D is a diagrammatic illustration of a medical device of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (11) FIG. 6 is a diagrammatic illustration of a medical device located in a vessel.
- (12) FIGS. 7A to 7E are diagrammatic illustrations of medical device of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (13) FIG. 8A is a diagrammatic illustration showing electrode mounting platforms of a medical device of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (14) FIG. 8B is a diagrammatic illustration showing placements of a medical device of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (15) FIG. 9 shows diagrammatic illustrations of different electrode configurations.
- (16) FIG. 10 shows diagrammatic illustrations of different electrode configurations.
- (17) FIG. 11 is a diagrammatic illustration of a medical device of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (18) FIG. 12 shows diagrammatic illustrations of different electrode configurations.
- (19) FIG. 13a is a diagrammatic illustration showing wire attachments to an electrode.
- (20) FIG. 13b is a diagrammatic illustration showing electrode lead wires wrapped around a shaft and covered in insulation forming a wire bundle or cable.
- (21) FIGS. 14 to 20 are diagrammatic illustrations showing different embodiments of the stent.
- (22) FIGS. 21a to 21c are diagrammatic illustrations showing deployment of different embodiments of the device.
- (23) FIGS. 21d and 21e show additional information regarding a helical lead 114.
- (24) FIGS. 22 to 24 are diagrammatic illustrations of a control unit of the system shown in FIG. 1.
- (25) FIGS. 25 and 26 are diagrammatic illustrations showing different stages of deployment of the device.
- (26) FIGS. 27 and 28 are diagrammatic illustrations of control units having ground electrodes attached thereto.
- (27) FIG. 29 is a diagrammatic illustration showing multiple vessels with multiple devices.
- (28) FIG. 30 is a diagrammatic illustration showing a single vessel with multiple devices.
- (29) FIG. 31 is a diagrammatic illustration of a wireless electrode system.
- (30) FIG. 32 is a diagrammatic illustration of the system being used to record neural information or stimulation of neurons from the superior sagittal sinus (SSS) or branching cortical veins of a patient using the device.

- (31) FIG. 33 shows an image reconstruction of a human brain (eyes facing left) demonstrating superior sagittal sinus and branching cortical veins near the motor cortex (red) and sensory cortex (yellow).
- (32) FIG. 34 is a diagrammatic illustration showing a method for stimulation and recording neural information or stimulation of neurons from the visual cortex of a patient using the device.
- (33) FIG. 35 is a diagrammatic illustration showing vessels and muscles in a human arm;
- (34) FIG. 36 is an illustration of a human hand showing possible implant location to enable neural stimulation or measurement.
- (35) FIG. 37 is a photo of a C-shaped ground electrode.
- (36) FIGS. 38A-38D illustrate examples of stents or scaffoldings having a plurality of electrodes disposed about the stent body.
- (37) FIGS. 39A-39C illustrate an example of integrated or embedded electrodes.
- (38) FIGS. 40A-40B show an example of a stent structure fabricated with dimensional variation to impart specific characteristics to the stent.
- (39) FIGS. 41A-41E illustrate a variation of a connector.
- (40) FIG. 42 illustrates a variation of a stent electrically coupled to a control panel and a connector.
- (41) FIGS. 43A-43G illustrate various views of a variation of a connection panel.
- (42) FIGS. 44A-44D illustrate a variation of an overlay.
- (43) FIGS. 45A and 45B illustrate a variation of an overlay.
- (44) FIGS. 46A-46F illustrate variations of stents having various electrode configurations.
- (45) FIGS. 47A-47F illustrate variations of stents having various electrode configurations.
- (46) FIGS. 48A-48D illustrate a variation of a stent.
- (47) FIGS. 49A-49C illustrate a variation of a stent.
- (48) FIGS. 50A-50C illustrate a variation of a stent.
- (49) FIGS. 51A and 51B illustrate a variation of a stent.
- (50) FIGS. 52A-52C illustrate a variation of a stent.
- (51) FIGS. 53A-53D illustrate a variation of a stent.
- (52) FIGS. 54A and 54B illustrate a variation of a stent.
- (53) FIGS. 55A and 55B illustrate a variation of a stent.
- (54) FIGS. 56A-56D illustrate variations of stents having various electrode configurations.
- (55) FIG. 57 illustrates a variation of a stent lattice structure.
- (56) FIGS. 58A-58D illustrate a variation of a stent.
- (57) FIGS. 59A-59C illustrate a telemetry unit lead having a snake and rung configuration.
- (58) FIGS. 60A-60D illustrate a variation of a system having a stent in communication with an external apparatus.
- (59) FIG. 61A illustrates a variation of a nerve cuff.
- (60) FIG. 61B illustrates the nerve cuff of FIG. 61A deployed around a nerve.
- (61) FIG. 62A illustrates a variation of a stent and cable connection.
- (62) FIG. 62B illustrates a variation of a stent and cable connection.
- (63) FIG. 62C illustrates a variation of a close-up of section 62C-62C of FIG. 62B.
- (64) FIG. 62D illustrates a variation of a stent and cable connection.
- (65) FIG. 62E illustrates a variation of a stent and cable connection.
- (66) FIG. 62F illustrates a variation of the cross section 62-62 of FIG. 62E.
- (67) FIG. 62G illustrates a variation of the cross section 62-62 of FIG. 62E.
- (68) FIG. 62H illustrates a variation of a stent and cable connection.
- (69) FIGS. 63A-63K illustrate variations of stents having various stent, electrode and electrode track configurations.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (70) The system 10 shown in FIGS. 1 to 4 includes: 1) a medical device 100 designed for placement within a vessel 103 of an animal or human 110 to stimulate and/or sense the activity of

media (tissue and fluids) proximal (adjacent or touching) to the device **100**, whether this be located inside or outside the vessel **103**; 2) a control unit **12** (also referred to as a connector block and telemetry system) adapted for communication with the device; 3) a communication conduit **14** for facilitating communications between the device **100** and the control unit **12**; and 4) apparatus **16** coupleable to the animal or human **110**, the apparatus **16** adapted for communication with the control unit.

(71) The control unit **12** can be adapted to perform the steps of: (a) receiving data from the device **100** representing activity of media proximal to the device **100**; (b) generating control signals for the apparatus **16**; and (c) sending the control signals to the apparatus **16**. In some variations, the system includes connector block (illustrated by element **12**) that functions as connector and acts as an extension of the communication conduit. In variations of the system, the control unit/connector block: is hermetically sealed and insulates the leads from the device to the control unit; can be inserted using zero-contact force attachments or attachments that do not require excessive force to insert (i.e., using balseal spring contacts); has a portion of the lead that is made from a stiffer silicone or similar material for handling and insertion into the connector. Variations of the device can include markers to identify portions of the leads that are stiffer (and can be handled) to distinguish from leads that cannot be handled. Such markers can include line-style markers, different colours or other indicators to clearly identify the regions. Variations of the connector block can have a fitting (e.g., clasp) such that multiple connectors can be inserted (i.e., two contact connectors (with 8 contacts each) for a 16 electrode Stentrode lead). The fitting can ensure securing of the contacts, alignment and prevention of water ingress

(72) When the medical device **100** is inserted adjacent to the motor cortex in the manner shown in FIGS. 2A, 2B, and 3, the system **10** can be used, for example, to control operation of an exoskeleton, and/or an artificial limb in the manner shown in FIG. 1.

(73) This device **100** is implanted into blood vessels **103**, from which, it will utilise electrodes mounted on a self-expanding member **101** to record or stimulate neighbouring tissue. Information is to be passed from or to the electrodes through the communication conduit **14**, inside of the blood vessel **103**, to a telemetry system **12** that, in turn, passes information (using wires or wirelessly) to or from an external apparatus **16**, which includes (but is not limited to) one or more of the following: (a) an exoskeleton; (b) wheelchair; (c) computer; and/or (d) other electrical or electro-mechanical device.

(74) As such, in one specific application, the implanted medical device **100** has the capability to enable a paralysed patient **110** to use their thoughts directly to command and control a gait aid such as an exoskeleton or robotic legs **16**.

(75) Other applications for the implantable medical device **100** include (but are not limited to): (a) detection and prevention of seizures; (b) detection and prevention of involuntary muscular or neural control (for example to alleviate symptoms associated with: (i) multiple sclerosis; (ii) muscular dystrophy; (iii) cerebral palsy; (iv) paralysis and (v) Parkinsons'; (c) detection and therapeutic alleviation of neurological conditions, such as: (i) post-traumatic stress disorder; (ii) obsessive compulsive disorder; (iii) depression; and (iv) obesity; (d) direct brain control of computers and equipment, such as: (i) vehicles; (ii) wheelchairs; (iii) gait aids; robotic limbs; (e) direct input for sensory stimulation for: (i) blindness (connection to a camera); (ii) deafness (connection to microphone); (iii) proprioception (connection to touch-sensitive robotic and computer systems); (f) internal assessment of personal health and wellbeing: (i) heart rate; (ii) respiration rate; (iii) temperature; (iv) environmental conditions; (v) blood sugar levels; and (vi) other biochemical and neurological markers; (g) internal communication (telepathy) between implanted groups of people utilising the device for information transmission, auditory, visual and proprioceptive feedback (for example, real time communication of what the implantee sees or hears); and (h) augmentation and optimisation of musculoskeletal control and dexterity (for performance enhancement or rehabilitation).

(76) FIG. 2B illustrates a two-stent **101** system. For purposes of illustration, the stents are positioned in a single vessel. However, the stents can be configured such that they can be positioned in separate vessels. The stents **101** can be joined by non-conductive material to form a power receiver and transmitting antenna. Alternatively, the stents can be coupled by one or more wires or conductive elements. Moreover, the system can include active electronics between the stents **101**.

(77) The devices described herein can be positioned in any number of areas of brain structures depending upon the desired outcome. For example, as discussed in Teplitzky, Benjamin A., et al. "Computational modeling of an endovascular approach to deep brain stimulation." *Journal of Neural Engineering* 11.2 (2014):026011, stents can be positioned as follows: Internal capsule for depression and obsessive compulsive disorder (OCD); thalamus for epilepsy (E), Parkinson's Disease, essential tremor, Tourette syndrome, consciousness disorder, chronic pain, obsessive compulsive behavior; fornix for Alzheimer's disease; globus pallidus internus for dystonia, depression, Tourette syndrome; hippocampus for epilepsy; hypothalamus for obesity, anorexia mentosa; inferior thalamic pundle for depression and obsessive compulsive disorder; lateral habenula for depression, obesity, anorexia mentosa; nucleus accumbens for depression, obsessive compulsive disorder, addiction, obesity, anorexia mentosa; periaqueductal/periventricular for chronic pain; subgenal cingulate white matter for depression; subthalamic nucleus for Parkinson's Disease, dystonia, depression, obsessive compulsive disorder, epilepsy; and ventral capsule for obsessive compulsive disorder.

(78) 1. Medical Device

(79) As shown in FIGS. 5a, 5b, 5d and 6, the medical device **100** generally includes: a. a collapsible and expandable stent **101**; b. a plurality of electrodes **131** coupled to the stent **101**; c. electrode lead wires **141** electrically coupled to electrodes **131**; d. an olive **112** coupled to the stent **101** by an olive wire **114** for preventing perforation of vessels during implantation; e. implanted chips; f. contacts **151** couple to the lead wires **141** to enable communication between the device **100** to the control unit **12**; and g. a stent shaft **121** is used to deploy the device **100**.

(80) Electrode lead wires **141** can be electrically connected to at least one electrode and will be wound around the stent strut lattice **108** such that mechanical compression and extension is not interfered with. Electrode wires **141** may be wound around the stent shaft **121**, thread through a stylet shaft or may form part of the stent shaft directly. Lead wires **141** will form connections with electrode contacts **151** on the opposite end of the stent shaft to the stent, whereby electrical contact a connector block mechanism **12** enables the connection path with external equipment **16**, which included but is not limited to computers, wheelchairs, exoskeletons, robotic prosthesis, cameras, vehicles and other electrical stimulation, diagnostic and measurement hardware and software.

(81) The term electrode **131** is used in this specification to refer to any electrical conductor used to make contact with media in and/or around a blood vessel **103**.

(82) A detailed description of the operation of each of these components is set out below.

(83) The Stent

(84) The stent **101** includes a plurality of struts **108** coupled together with strut crosslinks **109**.

(85) In the arrangement shown in FIG. 7a, the device **100** includes nine electrodes coupled to the stent **101** in a linear pattern. As shown, the stent **101** appears flat. The top of the stent **101** may be directly joined to the bottom of the stent **101** or will curve around to meet (without permanent attachment) the bottom of the stent **101**.

(86) Alternatively, the device **100** includes a stent with any suitable number of electrodes **131** arranged in any suitable configuration. For example, the electrodes can be configured as follows: the sinusoidal arrangement of electrodes **131** shown in FIG. 7b; the spiral arrangement of electrodes **131** shown in FIG. 7c to enable 360 degree contact of an electrode to the vessel wall once deployed; the reduced amplitude sinusoidal arrangement of electrodes **131** shown in FIG. 7d for increased coverage whilst still ensuring only one stent is at each vertical segment; and the dense

arrangement of electrodes shown in FIG. 7e for increased coverage. The stent **101** is laser cut or woven in a manner such that there is additional material or markers where the electrodes **131** are to be placed to assist with attachment of electrodes and uniformity of electrode locations. For example, if a stent **101** was fabricated by laser cutting material away from a cylindrical tube (original form of stent), and, for example, electrodes are to be located at 5 mm intervals on the one axis, then electrode mounting platforms **107**, **108** can be created by not cutting these areas from the tube. Similarly, if the stent is made by wire wrapping, then additional material **107**, **108** can be welded or attached to the stent wires providing a platform on which to attach the electrodes. Alternatively, stents can be manufactured using thin-film technology, whereby material (Nitinol and or platinum and or other materials or combinations of) is deposited in specific locations to grow or build a stent structure and/or electrode array

(87) Electrodes

(88) As particularly shown in FIGS. **8a**, the device **100** includes electrode placements **107** coupled to strut crosslinks **109**. The placements **107** are used to coupled the electrodes **131** to the stent. An alternative embodiment of the placements **106** is shown in FIG. **8b**. In this embodiment, the placements are circular.

(89) As shown, the electrodes **131** are located on or at the stent crosslinks **109**. Locating the electrodes in these positions allows for changes in shape of the stent **101** (i.e expanding and collapsing) without significantly affecting the integrity of the electrodes. Alternatively, may also be located in between the stent strut crosslinks (not depicted).

(90) FIG. **9** depicts different electrode geometries which include but are not limited to: flat discs **161**; cylinders or rings **162**; half-cylinders or rings **163**; spheres, domes or hemispheres **164**; hyperbolic paraboloids **165**; and double electrodes or electrodes whereby they are longer along one axis **166**.

(91) As shown in FIG. **10**, the electrodes **131** can include shape memory material and hence the electrodes **131** may be uninsulated sections of the device **100**. As shown, the electrode **131** inside a patient and the vessel **104** is unobstructed. After activation of shape memory, the electrode **131** conforms to better fit the vessel wall **103**.

(92) To enhance contact and functionality of the device **100**, electrodes **131** include the attachment of additional material (shape memory alloy or other conducting material) through soldering, welding, chemical deposition and other attachment methods to the stent **101** including but not limited to: directly on or between the stent struts **108**; to lead wires **14** passing from the electrodes **131** to wireless telemetry links or circuitry; and directly to an olive **112** placed on the distal aspect of the device **100** to or stent shafts.

(93) To further enhance the device **100** performance, there may be one or more electrodes **131** per wire strand **141** and there may be one or more strands **141** utilised per device **100**. These strands **141** may be grouped to form a bundle **144**, which may be woven in alternate sinusoidal paths around the stent struts **108** in the manner shown in FIG. **11**. Similarly, there may be one or more wires **141** designated to each electrode **131** and hence there may be one or more electrodes **131** per device **100**. Thus, multiple electrodes **131** may be used simultaneously.

(94) To optimise the ability of the electrodes **131** to stimulate or record from medium (including but not limited to neural tissue, vascular tissue, blood, bone, muscle, cerebrospinal fluid), the electrodes **131** may be positioned at pre-determined intervals based on the diameter of the target vessel **103** to allow each of the electrodes **131** to be in contact with the vessel **103** in the same orientation (ie, all electrodes facing to and in contact with the left vessel wall upon deposition). Electrodes **131** may be mounted such that recordings or stimulation can be directed to all 360 degrees of the vessel simultaneously. Similarly, to enhance the recording and stimulation parameters of the electrodes **131**, the electrode sizes may be varied, with larger electrodes **131** used to assess greater areas of neighbouring medium with smaller electrodes **131** utilised for localisation specificity.

(95) Alternatively, the electrodes **131** are made from electrically conductive material and attached to one or more stents, which form the device **100** and allow for multiple positions. In this embodiment, the electrodes **131** are made from common electrically active materials such as platinum, platinum-iridium, nickel-cobalt alloys, or gold, and may be attached by soldering, welding, chemical deposition and other attachment methods to one or more lead wires **141**, which may be directly attached to the shape memory shaft(s). The electrodes **131** can be one or more exposed sections on the insulated lead wire **141** and the electrode lead wires may be wrapped around one or more shape memory backbones. There may be one or more electrodes and lead wires wrapped around a single shape memory backbone, and, where multiple shape memory backbones are used in the one device, the backbones may have different initial insertion and secondary deposition positions. Thus, they may be used for targeting multiple vessels simultaneously.

(96) As shown in FIG. **12**, the electrodes **131** can be designed such that they are carriers of substances **134** and solutions such as therapeutic drugs, including but not limited to anti-thrombogenic, and materials. In this embodiment, the electrodes **131** are designed to release the drugs, either passively through diffusion or through control by an implanted electrical clock or manually through electrical stimulation of the electrodes **131**. In this embodiment, the electrodes **131** are made from materials that have portions of the electrodes **131** that are not electrically conductive.

(97) The drug **134** can be released into the vessel **104** upon timed, natural, electrical or otherwise activation, or into the vessel wall **103**.

(98) Electrode Wires

(99) The electrode wires **141** are electrically coupled to respective electrodes in the manner shown in FIG. **13a**. As shown, the electrical attachment **135** and the back face of the electrode is covered in a non-conductive substance **136**.

(100) The lead wires **141** can be wrapped around the stent **101** and along a shaft **121**.

(101) As shown in FIGS. **5a**, **5b** and **13b**, the electrode lead wires **141** are wrapped around the shaft **121** and covered in insulation **122** forming a wire bundle or cable. A sleeve **153** wraps around the wire bundle at the location of the contact **151**, whereby at least one wire **141** is wrapped around the sleeve **153** and connected to the contact **151** at a connection weld point **152**. The over-molding **154** ensures a uniform diameter is present between contacts.

(102) The sleeve **153** covers the wire bundle **142** with an exposed section of wire **141** attached **152** to a contact **151**.

(103) Distal electrodes and/or markers and/or buffers are also depicted **112** attached via a wire **114** to the stent **101**. The shaft **121** is attached at the end of the stent at the attachment/detachment zone **115** and is shown passing through the sleeve **142** and electrode contacts **151** to exit behind past the connector securement point **155**.

(104) The lead wires **141** shown to be inside the sleeve **142** where they are wrapped around the shaft **121** where they make electrical contact at a contact weld **152** to the electrode contacts **151**. An overcoat **154** is shown to ensure uniform diameter of the device between the contacts. The shaft **121** may be detached at the detachment zone **115** and removed following deployment in a vessel.

(105) As shown in FIG. **13b**, lead wires **141** are connected to electrode contacts **151**. Electrode lead wires **141** are initially wrapped around a shaft **121** covered in insulation **122** forming a wire bundle or cable. A sleeve **153** is placed around the wire bundle at the location of the contact, whereby at least one wire **141** is wrapped around the sleeve and connected to the contact **151** at a connection weld point **152**. Over-molding **154** may be used to ensure a uniform diameter is present between contacts.

(106) As particularly shown in FIG. **5b**, the stent shaft **121** is coated in an insulative layer **122**, has a plurality of wires **141** that are insulated **143** and grouped in an insulated bundle **142** wrapped around it. A sleeve **153** covers the wire bundle **142** with an exposed section of wire **141** attached **152** to a contact **141**.

(107) The wires **141** are made from electrically conductive materials including but not limited to Platinum, Platinum/Tungsten, Stainless Steel, Nitinol, Platinum/Iridium, Nickel-Cobalt Alloys, or other conductive and biocompatible materials.

(108) The wires **141** are between 10 um and 100 um thick (diameter), stranded cable or monofilament, and connect the electrodes **131** to the contacts **151**. Alternatively, the wires **141** connect the electrode **131** to wireless circuitry retained on the stent or shaft.

(109) The wires **141** are insulated with non-conductive material (ie, Teflon or polyimide). The wires **141** are wrapped around the stent struts in a sinusoidal pattern as shown in FIG. **11**. Alternatively, the wires **141** are wrapped in a helical tube or wire bundle or cable, with the wire or bundle between 300 um and 2 mm in diameter (thickness)

(110) The wires **141** are connected to contacts **151** using wire wrapping, conductive epoxy, welding, or other electrically conductive adhesion or connection means.

(111) Olive

(112) In the embodiment shown in FIG. **5a**, the device **100** includes an olive **112** mounted at the distal tip to reduce risk of perforation and to improve device **100** safety during the implantation and deposition phase. In this arrangement, the olive **112** is directly connected to the front of the device **100** and act as a buffer, which is the first aspect of the device that comes in contact with the deployment catheter or the vessel during deployment. The olive **112** can additionally be used as a radiopaque distal marker. The olive **112** can be configured and attached to the stent **101** in many different forms including, but not limited to, the following:

(113) i. Flexible Cord

(114) As shown in FIG. **5a**, the olive **112** is placed at a distance from the front of the stent **101**, connecting with the stent **101** via a flexible cord **114**.

(115) ii. Spring Olive

(116) FIG. **14** depicts an olive placed on the distal end of a stent **101** whereby the olive is comprised of a buffer which may or may not be electrically active and function as an electrode **112** connected to the stent **101** by a flexible spring or helically wound wire **111**.

(117) iii. Multiple Olives

(118) FIG. **15** depicts a plurality of olives placed on the distal end of a stent **101** whereby the olive is comprised of a plurality of buffers which may or may not be electrically active and function as an electrode **113**.

(119) iv. Short Olive

(120) FIG. **16** depicts an olive placed on the distal end of a stent **101** whereby the olive is connected directly to the end of the stent which may or may not be electrically active and function as an electrode **112**.

(121) v. Shaped Wire Olive

(122) FIG. **17** depicts an olive placed on the distal end of a stent **101** whereby the olive is a flexible wire which may or may not be electrically active and function as an electrode and may or may not be shaped as a shepherds crook **114**.

(123) vi. Wire Olive

(124) FIG. **18** depicts an olive placed on the distal end of a stent **101** whereby the olive is comprised of a buffer which may or may not be electrically active and function as an electrode **112** connected to the stent **101** by a flexible wire **114**.

(125) vii. Olive with Detachment Zone

(126) FIG. **19** depicts an olive placed on the distal end of a stent **101** whereby the olive is comprised of a buffer which may or may not be electrically active and function as an electrode **112** connected to the stent **101** by a flexible wire **114**. This figure further depicts a shaft **121** that is connected to the stent **101** via an attachment and/or detachment zone **115**.

(127) FIG. **20** further depicts the shaft **121** that is detached from the stent **101** via the attachment and/or detachment zone **115**.

(128) The flexible wire **114** includes but is not limited to electrically conductive and electrically insulating wires, springs, helical leads and tubes which may have a buffer at the front. Alternatively, the buffer is electrically conductive and acts as an electrode, comprising all the features of stent-mounted electrodes.

(129) Implanted Chips

(130) Implanted electrical circuitry (chips) can be used to control the stimulation and measurement of the electrodes **131**. The chip can be implanted in place of an electrode (or elsewhere mounted on the stent), where the chip has the capacity to transmit the signals. The chip includes circuitry for: (a) signal amplification; (b) signal multiplexing; and (c) transmission of power and data.

(131) The electrodes **131** are attached to one or more electrical chips (whereby the chip is defined as the electrical circuitry as well as the substrate which the chip is built on). Miniaturised chips are mounted on the stent **101** in a similar manner and position to the electrodes **131**.

(132) Alternatively, these chips may be attached at a distance from the neural recording or stimulation site such as the neck or pectoral region, or the chip may connect directly to external hardware, such as current sources, recording equipment or prostheses.

(133) The chips can include circuitry for stimulation of neural tissue (current and/or voltage sources, batteries and/or capacitors or charge/energy storing components and switch matrices, etc) and circuitry for the recording of neural activity (amplifiers, power sources, switch matrices, etc) and blood composition (such as pH meters, salts and saline composition, glucose etc).

(134) Further, chips may have circuitry required for the transmission of power and data through telemetry coils and self-monitoring hardware such as thermal sensors.

(135) The depiction of the wireless chip **195** shown in FIG. 5c, whereby the microprocessor **191** is shown as well as other components **193** (eg, capacitors, multiplexors, clocks, wireless transmitters, receivers etc). This depiction has two coils that can be used for transmission and receiving of both power and data, shown as a large coil **192** and a small coil **194**.

(136) The chip itself may contain a telemetry coil for the transmitting and receiving power and data and may contain a magnet to enable alignment with adjacent chips and telemetry coils or may be attached to shape memory alloys or other materials in which the telemetry coils are comprised.

(137) The chip can be flexible, and may be pre-curved to the diameter of the vessel to allow for the deposition of the chip within a vessel. Thus, the chip may contain shape memory alloys or polymers to conform the chip to the curvature of the vessel during the deposition phase. The chip may also be mounted on a bioabsorbable or biodegradable substrate to allow for integration within a vessel. Multiple chips may be used simultaneously.

(138) f. Contacts

(139) As particularly shown in FIGS. 5a and 5b, electrode contacts **151** are required to enable connection of the device **100** to external equipment in the situation where wireless circuitry is not employed. The electrode contacts **151** can be made from materials similar to those used by the electrodes and will be of similar diameters. The contacts **151** are electrically insulated from each other and will be connected to the electrode lead wires **141** by (but not limited to) conductive epoxy, laser or resistance welding, soldering, crimping and/or wire wrapping.

(140) The contacts **151** are platinum rings or rings of other conductive, biocompatible materials. The contacts can be made from or contain magnetic materials (ie, Neodinium).

(141) The contacts **151** can be: (a) between 500 μm and 2 mm in diameter; (b) between 500 μm and 5 mm in length; and (c) between 10 μm and 100 μm in thickness.

(142) The contacts **151** are shaped as discs, tubes, paraboloids or other shapes similar to those used for the electrodes **131**.

(143) The contacts are placed over non-conducting sleeve (including but not limited to a silicone tube, heat shrink, polymer coating) to assist with electrical insulation of other lead wires and electrode and stent wire, and to assist in retaining shape tubular shape whilst allowing some flexibility.

(144) The contacts **151** can have a contact to contact separation of between 100 μm and 10 mm, for example, between 1.0 mm and 3.0 mm (e.g., 2 mm or 2.46 mm). Other contact separation dimensions, more or less, as well as other ranges, narrower or wider, are also appreciated.

(145) The contacts **151** are formed through wire wrapping of the wires **141**.

(146) At least one contact **151** can be a dummy connector (including but not limited to a metal ring, magnetic ring, plastic tube). A dummy connector in this instance is a connector that is not in electrical contact with an electrode, instead, the purpose is to enable a connection or securing point (ie, through a screw terminal) to the device in a desired location and such that the contacts (connected to electrodes) are not damaged.

(147) The contacts **151** are separated by a non-conductive sleeve (including but not limited to a silicone tube, heat shrink, polymer coating) to reduce electrical noise and prevent contact between superficial lead wires **141**.

(148) g. Shaft

(149) As shown in FIG. **21a**, to enable deployment, a flexible shaft **121** is connected to the device **100**. In the example shown in FIG. **21a**, the shaft **121** is connected at the distal end of the device **100** such that it acts to pull the device **100** from the front.

(150) In the alternate embodiment shown in FIG. **21b**, the shaft **121** is attached to the proximal end of the device **100** such that the shaft **121** pushes the device **100** from the back of the stent **101**. In this embodiment, medical device **100** includes a plurality of electrodes **131** mounted to a stent **101** with electrode lead wires **141** wrapped around the stent **101** and the shaft **121** and covered in a sleeve **142**. Distal electrodes and/or markers and/or buffers are also depicted **113** as is the stent detachment zone **105**.

(151) The further embodiment shown in FIG. **21c** includes a double tapered stent **101** with mounted electrodes **131** and a stent shaft **121** attached to the stent **101** at the stent attachment/detachment zone **105**. Another attachment/detachment zone **115** at the front of the stent **101** connects the stent **101** to the olive wire **114** and a stylet sleeve **124**, through which, a removable stylet **123** is placed. Electrode wires **141** are shown as wrapped around the outside of the stylet sleeve **123** or as being fed through the centre.

(152) There may be a plurality of wires, with both pushing and pulling abilities. The stent shafts **121** may be implanted permanently or may be designed to be detached and removed. In this embodiment, the attachment/detachment zone will be located at the junction of the stent shaft **121** and the stent **101**. Detachment methods include, but are not limited to, electrochemical detachment, mechanical detachment and thermo-electrical detachment.

(153) The stent shaft **121** can be used as a backbone for electrode lead wires **141**, assisting the stability of the electrode lead wires **141** as they traverse from the electrodes **131** to the electrode contacts. In this embodiment, the electrode wires **141** are in a polymer **142**, (including but not limited to shrink wrap, heat shrink, parylene, silicone, Teflon, etc) to provide additional mechanical support, assist in water retention and to enable coatings to be deposited onto the stent shaft where wires are present.

(154) The stent shaft **121** may be a stylet that is removed following implantation and deposition of the device **100**. In this embodiment, the stent shaft **121** may be a cylindrical tube such that the stylet **123** can be fed through the centre of the tube **121**.

(155) The wires **141** can be thread through the middle of a stylet sleeve.

(156) The wires **141** can be wrapped around the stent shaft or stylet sleeve.

(157) In a further embodiment, the electrode wires **141** that connect the electrodes **131** to the contacts **152** are wrapped in a wire bundle **144** and wrapped around an internal lumen tubing **145** in a helical form such that there is an internal lumen **147** whereby a removable stylet **148** can be thread during insertion and removed following deployment. This embodiment enabled removability of the stylet **148** and flexibility of the wire bundle **144** that is over coated in an external tubing **146**.

(158) FIGS. **21d** and **21e** show additional information regarding a helical lead **114**. As depicted, the

helical **114** lead includes wire bundle **144** wrapped around an internal lumen tube **145**. Through the internal lumen **147**, a removable stylet **148** can be thread during delivery and removed following device placement

(159) Control Unit

(160) The control unit **12** shown in FIG. **2** is a wireless controller, relaying information and power through the skin wirelessly.

(161) The connector block **12** in FIGS. **22**, **23**, and **24** are passive devices (ie, no circuitry). Essentially, it functions as an intermediate connection between the device **100** and external equipment. The device **100** is inserted into the connector block **12** whereby the device **100** contacts make electrical contact with internal contacts contained within the connector block **12**. These internal contacts of the connector block **12** then form a thicker wire bundle which passes through the skin (the rest of the connector block is implanted) and can be connected to external equipment.

(162) Essentially, as we are limited in space (the entire device must pass through a catheter as the catheter needs to be removed over the device after implantation) the connector block enables attachment of larger items to the thin device **100**.

(163) The embodiments shown in FIGS. **22**, **23** and **24** are the same, although only FIG. **24** shows the wire that goes through the skin.

(164) The control unit **12** shown in FIG. **22** is shaped to receive and make electrical connection with the lead **14**. The control unit include contacts rings mounted on the inside. Here, the connector block **12** is secured and ensured water-tight through attachment of silicone and/or sutures at the grooved end.

(165) The wireless system that is implanted on the stent directly is essentially the same (although a miniaturised version) of the wireless system **12** in FIG. **2**.

(166) As shown in FIG. **23**, the electrode lead **14** is inserted and a silicone gasket is used to make a watertight seal following

(167) FIG. **24** depicts a connector block whereby the electrode lead **14** is thread through the connection opening **172** whereby the contacts connect with the electrically conductive connectors **175** inside the connector block body **173**. Separation and electrical insulation and water-tightness is increased through silicone (or otherwise) separators **174**. Contacts **175** are welded (or otherwise) to connector block wires **179** that may form a silicone or otherwise **181** encased bundle **181** to terminate at a wireless or direct electrical connection port **183**.

(168) Method of Using the System

(169) The device **100** is movable between an insertion position shown in FIG. **25** and the deposition or scaffolding position shown in FIG. **26**.

(170) In the insertion position, the device **100** is contracted and thus thin enough to be threaded through the vasculature pathway from within a catheter from an entry point (ie, the jugular vein) to a deposition point (eg, the motor cortex).

(171) When arranged in the deposition or scaffolding position, the device **100** is in an expanded condition where scaffold electrodes mounted on the outside of the stent **101** as pressed against the vessel wall. This expanded position anchors the device **100** in its location within the vessel **103**. Further, this deposition position is designed such that it has a minimal effect on blood flow integrity through the vessel **103** in which the device **100** is deposited. The scaffolding position may be synonymous to a spring, coil or helical strand, whereby the device **100** is in contact with the vessel wall only, reducing the effect on blood flow. Electrodes **131** may also be mounted on the inside of the stent **101** such that information from fluid flowing through the expanded stent **101** can be measured. For a stent **101** to be removed or relocated, additional shafts (other than that used for initial deployment) are required. These are explained in the context of this invention, with both single tapered and double tapered designs used.

(172) To enable the device **100** to be arranged in multiple positions, the material used is such that multiple states are possible. These materials include, but are not limited to, Nitinol and other shape

memory alloys and polymers. Further, to enhance the long term biocompatibility of the device **100**, the polymers may be bioabsorbable or biodegradable, with a time of degradation similar to the time in which fibrosis occurs over the device **100**. Hence, the electrodes **131** (which preferably are not designed to degrade, and may be made from Nitinol, shape memory alloys, conductive polymers, other non-shape memory alloys and inert and biocompatible metals such as platinum, iridium, stainless steel and gold) will be all that remains of the initial device **100** and will become embed inside the blood vessel **103**, further enhancing the stability of the device **100** at the location of deposition

(173) Device in Blood Vessel (After Deployment)

(174) FIG. **6** depicts a medical device **100** in the expanded or deposition or scaffolding position. The device **100** includes a stent **101**, distal olives and/or proximity markers **112**, a wire **114** attaching the stent **101** to the olive **112**, a plurality of electrodes **131**, and an attachment/detachment zone **115** whereby the shaft is connected to the stent **101** having been deployed in a blood vessel **104**. Stent **101** mounted electrodes **131** are in direct apposition with the vessel wall **131** and are depicted as not interruptive of blood flow to any vessel (both the vessel the device is deployed in and other connected vessels). Here, the olive **112** can be used to direct the medical device into the desired vessel **104**.

(175) Device in Blood Vessel Pre-Deployment

(176) FIG. **25** depicts a medical device **100** during implantation (surgical deployment phase) as it is being thread through vessels **104** inside a catheter **102**. The stent **101**, electrodes **131**, stent detachment zone **105** and stent distal markers/electrodes/buffers **113** are shown, as are the vessel walls **103**. Here, the catheter **102** is being used to select and direct the device into the desired vessel **104**.

(177) Device in Blood Vessel After Deployment

(178) FIG. **26** depicts a medical device **100** in the expanded or deposition or scaffolding position comprising a stent **101**, distal olives and/or proximity markers **113**, a plurality of electrodes **131**, lead wires **141** and a stent detachment zone **105** being deployed in a blood vessel **104** through a deposition catheter **102**. Stent **101** mounted electrodes **131** are in direct apposition with the vessel wall **103** and are depicted as not interruptive of blood flow to any vessel (both the vessel the device is deployed in and other connected vessels).

(179) Ground Electrode

(180) The system can include a ground electrode **167**, configured in the manner shown in FIG. **27**, which is used to assist and improve the quality of the recorded signals or to provide an electrical return path for stimulation applications. Here the ground electrode may be placed on the connector block provided it is implanted. Ground electrode **167** can be directly attached to the outside of the wireless controller **12**.

(181) An alternative embodiment of the ground electrode **167** is shown in FIG. **28**. Ground electrode **167** on the outside of the controller **12**.

(182) The platinum C-shaped ground electrode **167** shown in FIG. **37** is embed in silicone **181** with a red helical lead wire **141** that is attached to a standard electrical terminal **169**. Dacron mesh is used to assist secure the electrode and wire to tissue.

(183) FIG. **29** shows a vessel with multiple devices **100** inserted in different vessels **104** to access different areas.

(184) FIG. **30** shows a single vessel **104** with multiple devices **100** implanted to cover a larger area.

(185) FIG. **31** a wireless electrode system **1000** showing electrodes mounted on a stent **101** within a blood vessel **104** overlying the motor cortex in a human that are picking up neural information and relaying this information to a wireless transmitter **1002** located on the stent **101**. Note the stent **101** has been deployed and the stylet has been removed (ie, only the stent **101**, electrodes, electrode wires and wireless system **1002** remains). The information is wirelessly transmitted through the skull to a wireless received **1004** placed on the head, which in turn, decodes and transmits the

acquired neural information to a prosthetic limb **16**.

(186) As shown in FIG. **32**, the device **100** can be used to record neural information or stimulation of neurons from the superior sagittal sinus (SSS) or branching cortical veins of a patient using the device **100**, including the steps of: (a) implanting the device in either the superior sagittal sinus or branching cortical veins; (b) receiving activity; and (c) generating data representing said activity; and (d) transmitting said data to a control unit. Stent **101** implanted in SSS over motor cortex acquiring (i.e. receives) signals that are fed through the wire to external equipment **12**.

(187) FIG. **33** shows an image reconstruction of a human brain (eyes facing left) demonstrating superior sagittal sinus and branching cortical veins near the motor cortex (red) and sensory cortex (yellow)

(188) FIG. **34** shows a method of for stimulation and recording neural information or stimulation of neurons from the visual cortex of a patient using the device **100**, including the steps of: (a) implanting the device in a vessel in the visual cortex of the patient; and (b) recording neural information associated with the vessel or stimulating neurons in accordance with received stimulation data.

(189) As particularly shown in FIG. **35**, the device **100** is delivered through a vessel **104** deposited in a muscle for direct muscular stimulation or recording.

(190) The device **100** can be delivered through a vessel adjacent to a peripheral nerve (such as shown in FIG. **35**) for stimulation or recording.

(191) The device is delivered through a vessel adjacent to a sympathetic or parasympathetic nerve for stimulation or ablation

(192) As shown in FIG. **36**, one example of a peripheral nerve (the median nerve in this example) showing possible implant location to enable neural stimulation or measurement.

(193) FIG. **38A** illustrates another example of a stent or scaffolding **101** having a plurality of electrodes **131** disposed about the stent **101** body. For purposes of illustration, the stent **101** is shown without any connecting structure that electrically couples the electrodes to leads or other such structure that allows electrical communication between the electrodes and control unit as described above. In the illustrated variation, the electrodes **131** are dispersed about the body of the stent **101** and are located at the joining or apex of joining struts **108**. In such a configuration, where instead of having cells shaped like diamonds, the cells are shaped like a 'V'. This configuration can enhance the apposition between the electrodes **131** and the tissue or vessel wall.

(194) FIG. **38A** also illustrates a variation of a stent **101** that can be fabricated where stent structure comprises an integrated conductive layer that extends through a portion or more of the stent strut **108** and where the electrode **131** is formed through an exposed portion of the integrated conductive layer. Such a stent configuration, as described in detail below, permits a stent **101** electrode **131** assembly, which embeds electrodes and conductive electrode tracks into the stent lattice or strut itself. Such a construction reduces or eliminates the requirement to use fixation methods (i.e., adhesives, glues, fasteners, welds, etc.) to mount electrodes to the body of the stent. Such a construction further reduces or eliminates the need to further weld or electrically connect electrodes to wires. Another benefit is that conventional wire-connected-electrodes require accommodation of the wires about the stent struts and through the body of the stent.

(195) FIG. **38B** illustrates a stent structure **101** with integrated electrodes **131**, where the stent structure is coupled to a shaft **121** at a distal end **146**. The shaft, as described herein, can electrically couple the electrodes **131** to one or more control units (not shown) as described herein. In one example, the shaft **121** can comprise a guidewire, push wire other tubular structure that contains wires or conductive members extending therein and are coupled to the conductive layer of the stent at the distal end **146**. Alternatively, FIGS. **38C** and **38D** shows a variation of stents **101** that can be fabricated such that the shaft **121** is part of or integral with the stent structure, where the conductive layer extends through a portion or all of the stent to the shaft **121**. Such a construction further eliminates the need for joining the shaft to the stent structure at the working end of the stent.

Instead, the joining of the stent structure (forming the shaft) to a discrete shaft can be moved proximally along the device. Such a construction allows the working end of the stent and shaft to remain flexible. The stent structures shown in FIGS. **38C** and **38D** can also include an optional reinforced section **62** as discussed above. FIG. **38C** further illustrates a hollow shaft **121**, which allows insertion of a stylet **123** therethrough to assist in positioning of the device or permits coupling of wires or other conductive members therethrough. Furthermore, the shaft **121** can include any number of features **119** that improve flexibility or pushability of the shaft through the vasculature.

(196) The electrical connection of the electrodes **131** to leads extending through the device can be accomplished by the construction of one or more connection pads (similar in construction to the electrodes described below) where the size of the pads ensures sufficient contact with the wire/lead, the type of pads ensures robustness and reduces track fatigue when crimped and attached. The section containing the pads can be compressed into a tube at, for example, distal section **146** to enable insertion of a cable **121**.

(197) In certain variations, the connection pads should be able to feed through the catheter. Furthermore, the connection pads **132** can include one or more holes or openings that enable visual confirmation that the pads are aligned with contacts on the lead. These holes/openings also enables direct/laser welding or adhesion of the contact leads (inside tube **121**) and the contact pads (on the inside of the tube spanning through the hole to the outside)

(198) In one example, a coaxial-octofilar cable (i.e. an inner cable with 8 wires positioned inside an outer cable having 8 wires) is used to enhance fatigue resistance and to ensure that wires can fit within constraints (i.e., can be inserted through a sufficiently small catheter, and can have an internal stylet as required).

(199) FIGS. **39A-39C** illustrate one example of a stent structure **101** constructed with an embedded electrode and conductive path. FIG. **39A** illustrates an example of a stent structure **101** in a planar configuration with electrodes **138** in a linear arrangement for purposes of illustration only. Clearly, any configuration of electrodes is within the scope of this disclosure. Specifically, in those variations of stent structures useful for neurological applications, the stent structure can comprise a diameter that is traditionally greater than existing neurological stents. Such increased diameter can be useful due to the stent structure being permanently implanted and while requiring apposition of electrodes against the vessel/tissue wall. Moreover, in some variations, the length of such stent structures can include lengths up to and greater than 20 mm to accommodate desired placement along the human motor cortex. For example, variations of the device require a stent structure that is sufficiently long enough to cover the motor cortex and peripheral cortical areas. Such lengths are not typically required for existing interventional devices aimed at restoring flow or addressing aneurysms or other medical conditions. In addition, in certain variations, the electrical path between certain electrodes can be isolated. In such a case, the electrically conductive material **50** can be omitted from certain stent struts to form a pattern that allows an electrode to have an electrical conduction path to a contact pad or other conductive element but the electrical conduction path is electrically isolated from a second electrode having its own second electrically conductive path.

(200) Placement of the electrodes in a specific pattern (e.g., a corkscrew configuration or a configuration of three linear (or corkscrew oriented) lines that are oriented 120 degrees from each other) can ensure a deployed electrode orientation that directs electrodes towards the brain. Once implanted, orientation is not possible surgically (i.e., the device will be implanted and will be difficult if not impossible to rotate). Therefore, variations of the device will be desirable to have an electrode pattern that will face towards the desired regions of the brain upon delivery.

(201) Electrode sizing should be of a sufficient size to ensure high quality recordings and give large enough charge injection limits (the amount of current that can be passed through the electrodes during stimulation without damaging the electrodes which in turn may damage tissue). The size

should also be sufficient to allow delivery via a catheter system.

(202) FIGS. **39B** and **39C** illustrates a cross-sectional view of the stent structure of FIG. **39A** taken along line **39B-39B** to further illustrate one variation of a manufacturing technique of using MEMS (microelectrical mechanical systems) technology to deposit and structure thin film devices to fabricate a stent structure with electrodes and a conductive path embedded into the stent lattice or struts. The spacing of the struts in FIGS. **39B** and **39C** are compressed for illustrative purposes only.

(203) As discussed above, embedding the electrode and conductive path presents advantages in the mechanical performance of the device. Furthermore, embedding of electrodes provides the ability to increase the number of electrodes mounted on the structure give that the conductive paths (30-50 $\mu\text{m} \times 200\text{-}500\text{ nm}$) can be smaller than traditional electrode wires (50-100 μm).

(204) Manufacture of thin-film stents can be performed by depositing Nitinol or other superelastic and shape memory materials (or other materials for deposition of electrodes and contacts (including but not limited to gold, platinum, iridium oxide) through magnetron sputtering in a specific pattern (**56**) using a sacrificial layer (**58**) as a preliminary support structure. Removal of the support structure (**54**) enables the thin film to be further structured using UV-lithography and structures can be designed with thicknesses corresponding with radial force required to secure the electrodes against a vessel wall.

(205) Electrical insulation of electrodes is achieved by RF sputtering and deposition of a non-conductive layer (**52**) (eg, SiO) onto the thin-film structure (**54**). Electrodes and electrode tracks (**50**) are sputter deposited onto the non-conductive layer (using conductive and biomedically acceptable materials including gold, Pt, Ti, NiTi, PtIr), with an additional non-conductive layer deposited over the conductive track tfor further electrical isolation and insulation. As shown, conducting path **50** is left exposed to form the electrode **138** (similarly, a contact pad area can remain exposed). Finally, the sacrificial layer **56** and substrate are removed leaving the stent structure **101** as shown in FIG. **39C**.

(206) In certain variations where the base structure **54** comprises superelastic and shape-memory materials (i.e. Nitinol), the stent structure **101** can be annealed in a high vacuum chamber to avoid oxidation during the annealing process. During heat treatment, the amorphous Nitinol structure **54** crystallizes to obtain superelasticity and can be simultaneously shape set into a cylindrical or other shape as desired. The structure **101** can then be heat treated.

(207) FIG. **40A**, which is a partial sectional view of taken along lines **40A-40A** of FIG. **41B**, illustrate an additional variation of a stent structure **101** fabricated via MEMS technology where one or more stent struts **108** can be dimensionally altered to impart desired structural or other aspects to the stent structure **101**. For example, in the illustrated variation, certain stent struts **108** are dimensionally altered such that the support material **60** comprises a greater thickness than adjacent stent structures **108**. However, such dimensional variation is not limited to thickness but can also include width, shape, etc.

(208) FIG. **40B** illustrates the stent structure **101** resulting from the dimensionally altered struts resulting in a sinusoidal section **62** of the stent structure **101** that comprises a greater stiffness (resulting from the increased thickness). Such a configuration allowing the stent device to be pushed through a catheter rather than conventional requirements to be unsheathed (where the sheath is pulled back over the stent). Conventional stents are made from a thin lattice of Nitinol diamonds or cells. This sinusoidal section **62** can function like a backbone and gives forward pushing strength to the device without restricting super-elasticity and the ability for the stent to compress and expand. Clearly, any number of variations of dimensionally altered strut sections are within the scope of this disclosure.

(209) FIGS. **41A-41E** illustrate various aspects of a variation of a connector **200** that can be in electrical communication with a stent (e.g., stent **101**) and a receptacle (e.g., control unit **12**). For purposes of illustration, the connector **200** is shown isolated from the stent **101** and the receptacle

12. As described above, the connector **200** can allow electrical communication between the electrodes and the control unit.

(210) FIG. **41A** illustrates that the connector **200** can have a dual-octofiler cable (also referred to as a coaxial-octofiler cable). The dual-octofiler cable can have a first coil **201** (e.g., inner coil) and a second coil **202** (e.g., outer coil). The first and second coils **201**, **202** can each have 8 wires **141**. Other numbers of wires, more or less, are also appreciated. The first coil **201** can be positioned within a lumen of the second coil **202**. The first coil can be positioned within a lumen of an internal tubing **145**. The first and/or second coils **201**, **202** can be positioned within a lumen of an external tubing **146**. The first and second coils **201**, **202** can be wound coils. The first and second coils **201**, **202** can be helical coils. For example, the first coil **201** can be wrapped along an inner surface of the internal tube **145** and the second coil **202** can be wrapped along an outer surface of the internal tube **145**. As described above, the dual-octofiler configuration can be used to enhance fatigue resistance and to ensure that wires can fit within constraints (i.e., can be inserted through a sufficiently small catheter, and can have an internal stylet as required).

(211) An insulator (e.g., polyurethane) can cover one or more wires **141** of the coils **201**, **202** (i.e., the wires **141** can be insulated). An insulator (e.g., polyurethane) can be positioned between the first and second coils **201**, **202**. For example, the internal tube **145** can be an insulator that can be positioned between the first and second coils **201**, **202**. An insulator (e.g., polyurethane) can cover the first and/or second coils **201**, **202** (i.e., the first and second coils **201**, **202** can be insulated).

(212) The first coil **201** can have a length that is less than, greater than, or equal to the length of the second coil **202**. For example, the first coil **201** can be longer than the second coil **202**. The first coil **201** can have a diameter that is less than, greater than, or equal to the diameter of the second coil **202**. The first and/or second coils **201**, **202** can each have one or more diameters. For example, the first coil **201** can have two diameters and the second coil **202** can have one diameter. The first coil **201** can have a first diameter and a second diameter. The first diameter can correspond to where the first coil **201** is positioned within the second coil **202** and the second diameter can correspond to where the first coil **201** is not positioned within the second coil **202** (e.g., where it extends past the first coil **201**). Other arrangements are also appreciated.

(213) Although not shown in FIG. **41A**, the external shaft **146** can comprise contacts **151** and separators **174** (e.g., insulators). The separators **174** can be positioned next to contacts **151** to keep the contacts **151** electrically insulated from one another. The wires **141** of the first and second coils **201**, **202** can be electrically connected to the contacts **151**. For example, the 8 wires **141** of the first coil **201** and the 8 wires **141** of the second coil **202** can each be electrically coupled to a corresponding contact **151**.

(214) The first coil **201** can allow a stylet **148** (not shown) to travel through it. For example, the first coil **201** can define a lumen that allows a stylet **148** to pass through the first coil **201**. The inner surface of the first coil **201** can be insulated and/or not insulated.

(215) The first and second coils **201**, **202** can have a wound section and an unwound section. For example, the first and second coils **201**, **202** can transition from a wound section to an unwound section. The wound section have helical wires and the unwound section can have straight, curved (e.g., have one or more bends), and/or angled (e.g., have one or more bends) wires. The wound and unwound sections can be flexible and/or rigid. For example, the wound section can be flexible and the unwound section can be rigid.

(216) The first and second coils **201**, **202** can have a helical section and a non-helical section. For example, the first and second coils **201**, **202** can transition from a helical section (e.g., where the wires **141** define a helix) to a non-helical section (e.g., where the wires **141** do not define a helix). For example, the wires **141** in the non-helical section can be unwound to no longer form a coil. The wires **141** in the non-helical section can be straight, curved (e.g., have one or more bends), and/or angled (e.g., have one or more bends). The helical and non-helical sections can be flexible and/or rigid. For example, the helical section can be flexible and the non-helical section can be rigid.

(217) The first and second coils **201**, **202** can each have one or more channels. For example, the first and second coils **201**, **202** can each have 8 channels. Other numbers of channels, more or less, are also appreciated (e.g., 9 to 16 channels, or more). Other numbers of coils are also appreciated, for example, 3 or more coils. For example, it will be appreciated that another coil can be positioned within the lumen of the first coil **201** and/or on the outside of the second coil **202**.

(218) FIG. **41B** illustrates a cross-sectional view of the connector **200** shown in FIG. **41A** taken along the line **41A-41A** to further illustrate the first and second coils **201**, **202** of the dual-octofiler coil configuration. FIG. **41B** also illustrates that the first coil **201** can step-up **203** in diameter to match or otherwise approach the diameter of the second coil **202**. The step-up **203** can occur somewhere along the length of the first coil **201** and somewhere along the length of the second coil **202**. For example, the first coil **201** can step-up **203** at about the midpoint of the first coil **201** and at an end of the second coil **202** (e.g., a terminal end). The first coil **201** can step-up **203** to contact the leads **151**, for example, so that uniformly sized leads **151** can be used. The first coil **201** can step-up **203** to attach to the leads **151**. However, it will be appreciated that the leads **151** can have one or more sizes. With or without the step-up **203**, the receptacle **12** can have a step in it so that the contacts **175** of the receptacle **12** can make contact with the contacts **151** in contact with the first coil **201**. The various components of the dual octofilar cable can have the various dimensions shown (in inches).

(219) FIG. **41C** illustrates another perspective view of the connector **200** of FIG. **41A**, but with the outer shaft **146** made transparent for purposes of illustration. As described above, the second coil **202** can be wrapped around the inner shaft **145** and the first coil **201** can have a step-up **203**. FIG. **41C** illustrates that the 8 wires **141** of the first and second coils **201**, **202** can have terminal ends **207**. As shown, the wires **141** of the second coil **202** can terminate first, followed by the wires **141** of the first coil **201**. The terminal ends **207** of the second coil **202** can attach to the first 8 leads **151** of the connector **200** and the terminal ends **207** of the first coil **201** can attach to the second 8 leads **151** of the connector **200**. The first 8 leads **151** can be closer to a first end **210a** of the connector **200** and the second 8 leads **151** can be closer to a second end **210b** of the connector **200**. Any connection sequence is appreciated, including, for example, connecting from proximal to distal (e.g., from first end **210a** to second end **210b**) as shown, from distal to proximal, alternating, etc. The terminal ends **207** can be electrically coupled to contacts **151** as described above (e.g., by welding). The terminal ends **207** can be exposed to the contacts **151** to establish an electrical path between the leads **151** and the electrodes **131**, **138**.

(220) FIG. **41C** also illustrates that the helix angle of the second coil **202** can change, for example, at position **204**. The helix angle of the second coil **202** can increase or decrease. For example, the helix angle can increase near where the second coil **202** makes contact with the first contact **151**. Other numbers of changes in the helix angle of the second coil **202**, more or less, are also appreciated (e.g., including zero change to two or more changes).

(221) FIG. **41D** illustrates another perspective view of the connector **200** of FIG. **41A**, but with the inner and outer shafts **145**, **146** made transparent for purposes of illustration. FIG. **41D** illustrates that the helix angle of the first coil **201** can change, for example, at position **205**. The helix angle of the first coil **201** can increase or decrease. For example, the helix angle can increase near where the last terminal end **207** of the second coil **202** makes electrical contact with an eighth contact **151**. Other numbers of changes in the helix angle of the first coil **16**, more or less, are also appreciated (e.g., including zero change to two or more changes).

(222) FIG. **41E** illustrates the connector **200** of FIG. **41A** with the leads **151** and separators **174** shown. The leads and separators **151**, **174** can be positioned relative to one another in an alternating pattern. As described above, each wire **141** of the first and second coils **201**, **202** terminate on a contact **151**. The wires/filars **141** are exposed and attached (e.g., welded) to the inner surface (e.g., inner diameter) of the leads **151**.

(223) The connector **200** can be inserted into and/or attached to a receptacle **12** as described above.

The connector **200** can be plugged into a receptacle **12** as described above. FIG. **41E** illustrates that the connector **200** can have a retention member **206** (e.g., retention ring **206**) that can engage with and/or attach to the receptacle **12**. To accomplish this, the retention member **206** can form a ring or a ring-like structure, although other shapes are also appreciated. For example, the receptacle **12** can be screwed onto the retention member **206**. The retention member **206** can have internal and/or external screw threads. For example, the retention member **206** can comprise a set screw. The retention member **206** can have a longer longitudinal dimension than one of the contacts **151**.

(224) The retention member **206** can be rigid to provide the connector **200** with structural support before, during and after implantation. Other parts of the connector **200** can be flexible so that the connector **200** can navigate or otherwise conform to the tortuosity of a blood vessel. For example, the portion of the connector **200** that is between the retention member **206** and the second end **210b** of the connector **200** can be flexible (this portion is also referred to here as the lead body). The lead body of the connector **200** can flex 90 degrees around a 6 mm radius. Other angles and radii, more or less, are also appreciated. The connector **200** (e.g., the second end **210b** of the connector **200**) can flex 45 degrees around a radius of 0.5 mm. Other angles and radii, more or less, are also appreciated. The connector **200** can be looped around a 1 cm radius. Other loop radii, more or less, are also appreciated.

(225) In the lead body portion of the connector **200**, the coils **201**, **202** can be allowed to float such that they are not embedded in insulation. The coils **201**, **202** can be embedded in insulation within the retention member **206** and/or within the lead body portion. The separators **174** can be over-molded to ensure a uniform diameter is present between contacts.

(226) FIG. **41E** illustrates that the lead wires **141** can extend beyond the first end **210a** of the connector **200**. The lead wires **141** that extend beyond the first end **210a** of the connector **200** can be unwound (e.g., uncoiled) such that each wire **141** can individually connect to a connection panel (e.g., connection panel **220** described below), or otherwise connect to the connection panel in one or more bundles **144** of wires **141**. For example, the lead wires **141** can transition from coiled configurations into 16 tailed ends that can connect to the connection panel. The 16 tailed ends can be straight and/or curved. The connection panel can electrically couple the connector **200** to the electrodes **131**, **138**. For example, FIG. **41E** illustrates that the first and second coils **201**, **202** can be unwound and grouped into three bundles **144** of lead wires **141**. Other numbers of bundles, more or less, are also appreciated. Wires from the first and second coil **201**, **202** can be bundled with first coil **201** wires **141** and/or with second coil **202** wires **141**. It is appreciated that individual wires **141** and one or more bundles of wires **144** can extend from the connector **200** to connect with the connection panel. The wires **141** can unwind/uncoil over some dimension within the retention member **206** and/or over some dimension within the rest of the connector **200**. The wires **141** and/or bundles **144** that extend from the connector toward the stent **101** can be rigid and/or flexible.

(227) The wires **141** can be directly connected to the stent **101**, for example, with laser welding. For example, the wires **141** can be directly connected to pads on the stent **101**. The wires **141** can be indirectly connected to the stent **101**, for example, with wire bonding. For example, the wires **141** can be indirectly connected to pads on the stent **101** via connection to intermediate pads. The pads on the stent **101** can be wire bonded to the intermediate pads, for example, with jumper wires.

(228) FIG. **42** illustrates that the connector **200** of FIGS. **41A-41E** can be electrically coupled to the electrodes **131**, **138** of the stent **101** via a connection panel **220**. FIG. **42** illustrates that the wires **141** of the connector **200** can be indirectly connected to the stent **101** via the connection panel **220**. The connection panel **220** can have a first panel (e.g., an overlay) and a second panel (e.g., a stent electrode panel) electrically coupled together. The first and second panels can each have one or more connection pads. The pads can be made of platinum or other conductive materials. The wires **141** of the connector **200** can be electrically connected to one or more pads of the first panel and the conductive paths (also referred to as electrode tracks) of the stent **101** can be electrically connected to one or more pads of the second panel. One or more jumpers can be used to electrically

connect the first panel to the second panel. For example, one or more jumpers can be used to electrically connect the first panel pads to the second panel pads. The one or more jumpers can electrically connect the pads of the first panel to the pads of the second panel, thereby electrically connecting the leads **151** of the connector **200** to the electrodes **131**, **138** of the stent **101**. Attaching the wires/filars **141** to the first panel can advantageously provide a more stable and reliable connection than directly attaching the wires/filars **141** to the stentrode pads (e.g., to the second panel pads). The first and/or second panels can be attached to the connector **200**, for example, by welding or other attachment method. The first and second panels can each have 16 pads. Other numbers of pads, more or less, are also appreciated (e.g., 1 pad to 32 or more pads). An insulating material (e.g., epoxy) can cover the connection panel **220**.

(229) More than one connection panel **220** can be used. For example, two connection panels **220** can be used. The use of two connection panels **220** can advantageously make connections easier and give more space for wire management relative to the use of only one connection panel **220** since not all 16 wires **141** are connected to the same area when two connection panels are used. The use of multiple connection panels can help provide structural support to the connection panel region when the stentrode is being pushed out of the delivery system. For example, the use of multiple connection panels can help distribute the force/axial load that is applied when the system is pushed through a delivery system (e.g., a catheter). The use of multiple connection panels is also advantageous from a processing and fatigue resistance standpoint.

(230) The one or more connection panels **220** can be aligned with a backbone of the stent **101**. For example, the one or more connection panels **220** can be aligned with struts **108**, thicker struts **108**, and/or with a reinforced section **62**.

(231) The transition from the dual coils **201**, **202** to the leads **141** extending toward the panel **220** can include unwinding/uncoiling the first and second coils **201**, **202** as described above.

(232) The connector **200** (also referred to as an endovascular implantable lead) can be configured to transmit neural interface sensor data to an implantable telemetry unit (e.g., control unit **12**). The dual-octofiler coils **201**, **202** can advantageously withstand long term repetitive movement and trauma due to neck movements, among other movements. The use of dual-octofiler coils **201**, **202** can advantageously reduce noise due to muscle artifacts.

(233) The pads on the stent can be connected to the conductors in the lead body by a variety of methods including but not limited to resistance welding, laser welding (each involving direct contact between the pads on the Stentrode and the lead), and/or wire bonding (connection between the Stentrode and the lead via an intermediate pad).

(234) FIGS. **43A-43F** illustrate various views of a variation of a portion of a connection panel **220**. As shown, the connection panel **220** can have a first panel **222** (e.g., an overlay) attached to a portion of the stent **101**, for example, a second panel **224**. The second panel **224** can be a connection paddle. The second panel **224** can be integrated with or attached to the stent **101**. The second panel **224** can have multiple pads (not shown) and multiple electrode tracks **236**. The electrode tracks **236** can be electrically connected to the pads of the second panel **224**. The first panel **222** can have multiple pads **226** and multiple openings **228** (also referred to as windows or holes). The pads can be made of platinum or other conductive materials. The openings **228** can be aligned with or otherwise placed over the pads on the stent **101**. The first panel **222** can have the same number or a different number of pads **226** and openings **228**. For example, the first panel **222** can have 16 pads **226** and 16 openings **228**, although other numbers of pads and openings, more or less, are also appreciated (e.g., 1 to 32 or more pads and openings). As another example, the first panel **222** can have more pads **226** than openings **228**. As yet another example, the first panel **222** can have fewer pads **226** than openings **228**. The stent **101** can have the same number or a different number of pads as the number of openings **228** in the first panel **222**. For example, the stent **101** can have 16 pads and the first panel **222** can have 16 openings **228**. As another example, the stent **101** can have 16 pads and the first panel **222** can have fewer than 16 openings **228** (e.g., 4 or 8

openings).

(235) FIGS. **43A** and **43B** illustrate that the windows **228** can have a reduced cross-sectional area relative to the cross-sectional area of the pads **226**. This can advantageously increase/optimize the operating space on the first panel **222** for wire management. The pads and windows **226**, **228** can be arranged in various patterns to increase/optimize the operating space on the first panel for wire management. The pattern shown in FIGS. **43A** and **43B** is non-limiting, as any suitable pattern of pads and windows **226**, **228** is appreciated. The pads and openings **226**, **228** can have the various dimensions shown (in millimeters), for example, in FIG. **43G** (on the same drawing sheet as FIGS. **43A** and **43B**).

(236) FIGS. **43C** and **43D** illustrate that wire bonds **230** can be made between the pads on the stent **101** and the pads **226** on the overlay **222**. FIG. **43D** is a magnified view of the wire bonds **230** of FIG. **43C** at section **43D-43D**. One or multiple wires **232** can pass through each of the windows **228**. For example, two wires **232** are shown in FIGS. **43C** and **43D** passing through two different windows **228**.

(237) FIGS. **43E** and **43F** illustrate that the wires **141** can be attached (e.g., welded) to the pads **226** on the overlay **222**. FIG. **43F** is a magnified view of the wires **141** attached to the pads **226** of FIG. **43E** at section **43E-43E**. An insulating material **234** (e.g., epoxy) can cover at least a portion of the wires **141**.

(238) FIGS. **44A-44D** illustrate a variation of an overlay **222** for wire bonding to a stent **101**. The overlay **222** can have the various dimensions shown (in inches). The overlay **222** of FIGS. **44A-44D** is similar to the overlay **222** of FIGS. **43A-43F** except the pattern of the pads and openings **226**, **228** is different, and the openings **228** are larger. FIG. **44C** is a magnified view of one of the pads **226** of FIG. **44A** at section **44C-44C**. FIG. **44D** is a magnified view of the opening **228** of FIG. **44A** at section **44D-44D**. The pads and openings **226**, **228** can have the various dimensions shown (in inches). Wire bond pads can be placed in specific locations to enable all 16 electrode tracks to fit within the 900 μm width with enough separation that unwanted electrical connection is avoided. The overlay **222** can have a similar width to enable deployment through a 1 mm internal diameter catheter.

(239) FIGS. **45A** and **45D** illustrate a variation of an overlay **222** for wire bonding to a stent **101**. FIG. **45A** illustrates a top view of the overlay **222** and FIG. **45B** illustrates that the overlay **222** can be placed over the portion of the stent **101** having pads. The pads of the stent can be electrically connected to the electrodes **131** (not shown) via the electrode tracks **236**. The pads and openings **226**, **228** can have the various dimensions shown. This design, and similar changes to the pads on the stent **101**, can advantageously allow for linear attachment of the pads **226** to the wire bonding holes **228**, which can make manufacturing the connection panel **220** easier than, for example, the connection panel associated with FIGS. **44A-44D**.

(240) FIGS. **43A-45D** illustrate that the wires **141** can be indirectly connected to the stent **101**, for example, with wire bonding. The wires **141** can be indirectly connected to pads on the stent **101** via connection to intermediate pads **226** on the overlay **222**. Such an intermediate connection method can advantageously allow for thicker/stronger wires **141** to be used to connect the lead **200** to the overlay **222**. Welds from the overlay **222** to the stent **101** can overcome limitations on the stent **101** of having a small amount of platinum to weld to. This is advantageous relative to, for example, laser welding because laser welding typically requires more material which is melted to form a pool during welding. With a small amount of material, the melted pool can cause the track material to be sucked up into the pool, causing the tracks to break during manufacture.

(241) FIGS. **46A-46F** illustrate variations of stents **101** having various electrode **131** configurations. Each of these stents **101** can advantageously position electrodes **131** in a manner that, regardless of the manner in which the stent **101** is delivered into a vessel, there will always be sufficient electrodes **131** pointing to an information rich area of the brain (e.g., motor cortex, sensory cortex, among others) upon expansion from a compressed configuration. For purposes of

illustration, the stents **101** are shown without any connecting structure that electrically couples the electrodes **131** to leads or other such structure that allows electrical communication between the electrodes **131** and the control unit **12** as described above.

(242) As shown, the electrodes **131** can be dispersed about the body of the stents **101** at various locations. FIGS. **46A-46F** illustrate that the stents **101** can have one or more cell sizes and/or shapes (e.g., diamond-shaped, V-shaped, among others). For example, the stents **101** can have cells that are longer than they are wide ($L>W$). This can advantageously allow for greater compression and reduce the force required to retract the stents **101** into a delivery instrument (e.g., a stylet or delivery catheter) and reduce the force required to deploy the stents **101** from within the delivery instrument. The stents **101** can have one or more cells that are wider than they are long ($W>L$). The stents **101** can have some cells that are longer than they are wide ($L>W$) and some cells that are wider than they are long ($W>L$). Such cell variations can advantageously accommodate various vessel physiologies.

(243) One or more of the electrodes **131** can be attached to, embedded into, and/or otherwise integrated with the stents **101** as described above. For example, the stents **101** can have one or more integrated conductive layers (also referred to as electrode tracks and electrical tracks). The electrode tracks can have a thickness from about 200 μm to about 1000 μm . Other track thicknesses, more or less, as well as other ranges, narrower or wider, are also appreciated. Electrode tracks with these thicknesses can advantageously decrease the electrical resistance of the electrode track and provide more material (at the connection end) for welding. In FIGS. **46A-46F**, the electrode track thickness is the dimension into the page (i.e., not width or length, which can remain constant to reduce the overall thickness of the Stentrode struts where multiple tracks are present, such as the fork **302** on the far left of the figures). The thickness of the struts **108** (i.e., the material underneath the insulation layers and electrical tracks) can be from about 50 μm to about 100 μm , for example, 50 μm , 85 μm , or 100 μm . Other strut thicknesses, more or less, as well as other ranges, narrower or wider, are also appreciated. The strut **108** thickness can increase or decrease gradually and/or in a step-wise manner along the stent **101** (e.g., gradually increase from 50 μm to 85 μm or step up from 50 μm to 85 μm). Thicker struts can have a larger radial and axial force relative to thinner struts. The thicker struts can therefore advantageously increase the apposition between the stent **101** and a vessel wall. The thicker struts can therefore increase the ability of the stent **101** to be pushed forward and deployed from within a delivery instrument (e.g., a catheter). The stents **101** can be thickest near the forks **302** on the proximal end of the stents **101** and can be thinnest at the distal end of the stents **101**. The stents **101** can become thinner from the proximal end to the distal end. The stents **101** can have any suitable thickness(es), including a constant thickness.

(244) The configurations of struts **108** and cells shown in FIGS. **46A-46F** can enhance the apposition between the electrodes **131** and tissue or vessel walls when the stents **108** are in their expanded configuration. The strut and electrode configurations **108**, **131** can advantageously allow the stents **101** to be compressed into a catheter. The strut and electrode configurations **108**, **131** can advantageously allow the stents **101** to be expanded after being compressed in a catheter. The cells (e.g., their size and/or shape) and the electrode **131** positions can allow the stents **101** to compress and/or expand so that the struts and electrodes **108**, **131** do not physically interfere with the compression and/or expansion of the stents **101**. For example, the relative positions of the cells and the electrodes **131** can allow the stents **101** to compress and/or expand without getting stuck in a partially compressed configuration or a partially expanded configuration. The cells and the electrode **131** positions can help prevent electrodes and struts **131**, **108** from becoming snagged with one another during compression or expansion of the stents **101**. The relative positions of the cells and electrodes **131** can facilitate expansion and/or compression of the stents **101**. The struts can be curved and/or straight. The struts that define the cells can be curved and/or straight.

(245) To reduce the number of leads/wires from the stent **101** to external equipment, a multiplexing

unit (not shown) can be used. The multiplexing unit can be placed on the connection panel/paddle of the stent **101** (e.g., second panel **224**). The multiplexing unit can be placed on the stent **101**, for example, on a strut **108**. One or multiple multiplexors can be used. The multiplexing unit can be small enough so that it does not impede the radial force and flexibility of the stent **101**. Multiplexing can reduce the number of wires required. One or more wires can be used with a multiplexor to power and switch between the electrodes **131** as required. The stent **101** can be wirelessly powered.

(246) FIGS. **46A-58D** illustrate various arrangements of stent cells, but any open cell configuration is appreciated. Moreover, although not shown, one or more of the stent cells can be closed such that there is not an opening in the cell. For purposes of illustration, the stents **101** shown in FIGS. **46A-58D** are illustrated as having various lengths and various numbers of electrodes **131**. However, other lengths, greater or smaller, as well as other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated. The stent lengths shown in FIGS. **46A-58D** is not limiting. The length of the stents **101** can be increased, for example, by including more stent in the longitudinal direction. For example, the length of the stents **101** can be increased by increasing the number of cells and/or by increasing the length and/or width of the cells. Similarly, length of the stents **101** can be decreased, for example, by having less stent in the longitudinal direction. For example, the length of the stents **101** can be decreased by decreasing the number of cells and/or by decreasing the length and/or width of the cells. The open cell designs in FIGS. **46A-58D** are for illustrative purposes only as well. The cell arrangements shown can be repeated, changed, and/or altered to achieve the desired length of the stents **101** and/or the desired open cell design. FIGS. **46A-58D** illustrate various cell shapes and sizes, but any open cell configuration for the stents **101** is appreciated. For example, any of the cells in FIGS. **46A-58D** can be combined with one another to form a stent (e.g., stent **101**). The numbers of electrodes in FIGS. **46A-58D** can be increased or decreased as needed. For example, the stents **101** in FIGS. **46A-58D** can have between 1 and 32 or more electrodes **131** (the numbers of electrodes **131** in the figures are exemplary only). In this way, the stents **101** can advantageously accommodate various vessel physiologies and sense and/or stimulate various tissues in one or multiple locations.

(247) The stents **101** can have one or more sections of electrodes **131**. The one or more sections can be separated by one or more sections of struts **108** that do or do not have electrodes.

(248) As described above, the stents **101** disclosed and contemplated herein, for example, the stents **101** shown in FIGS. **46A-56D**, can stimulate and/or sense various activity of media (e.g., tissue and/or fluids). For example, the stents **101** can stimulate and/or sense activity of fluid inside a lumen of a vessel, activity of a vessel itself, and/or activity of media (e.g., tissue and/or fluids) outside of the vessel such as the motor and/or sensory cortex of the brain.

(249) FIG. **46A** illustrates that the stent **101** can have seven electrodes **131** arranged as shown. Other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated (e.g., between 1 and 32 or more electrodes). The seven electrodes **131** can span radially across a length of the vessel with no electrode overlap. For example, the seven electrodes **131** can span radially across a length of an 8 mm vessel with no electrode overlap. The seven electrodes **131** can be at different radial positions along a length of the stent **101** such that there is no overlap of electrodes **131** when the stent **101** is expanded in a vessel. The seven electrodes **131** can be at different circumferential positions along the length of the stent **101** such that there is no overlap of electrodes **131** when the stent **101** is expanded in a vessel. As described above, this can advantageously ensure that the stent **101** has a sufficient number of electrodes **131** pointing to information rich areas of the brain (e.g., the motor cortex, the sensory cortex, among other areas) upon expansion from a compressed configuration.

(250) FIG. **46A** illustrates that the stent **101** can have large cells and small cells. The small cells can be inside the large cells. The struts **108** can define the cells. Some of the struts **108** can define at least a portion of a small cell and at least a portion of a large cell. Some of the struts **108** can define at least a portion of a small cell or at least a portion of a large cell. The electrodes **131** can be

located on the small cells and/or the large cells. For example, the electrodes **131** can be integrated with the small cells. The electrodes **131** can be located anywhere on the small cells. For example, the electrodes **131** can be located at an apex of the small cells. The electrodes **131** can be located anywhere on the struts **108**. As shown, the electrodes **131** can be located at the distal longitudinal apexes of the small cells. Although not shown, the electrodes **131** can be located on a portion of the small cells away from the distal longitudinal apexes, including for example, the transverse and proximal apexes. The electrodes **131** can be indirectly coupled to the large cells. The small cells can be inside the large cells for advantageous electrode placement and to assist with electrode-vessel wall apposition. The stent **101** can have a full set of small closed cells on top for stent overlap (e.g., the top row of small closed cells in FIG. **46A**). The small cells can have a cell length L and a cell width W. The stent **101** can have a total length TL and a total width TW. The configuration in FIG. **46A** can enhance the apposition between the electrodes **131** and the tissue of a vessel wall.

(251) FIG. **46B** illustrates that the stent **101** can have sixteen electrodes **131** arranged as shown. Other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated. The electrodes **131** can be positioned in bipolar pairs for neural recording and stimulation efficiency. The bipolar pair arrangement can advantageously enable direct stimulation or recording from one electrode to another (e.g., between any two electrodes **131**). This can elicit a response or record a signal from a focal region of the brain in a region between the electrodes **131** that form the bipolar pair (as opposed to an electrode **131** and a distant ground, with the second or return electrode placed off the stent). The electrodes **131** can be independent from one another. The electrodes **131** can be used in pairs. The electrodes **131** can be used in multiple pairs, for example, by switching among the electrodes **131**. The electrodes **131** can be used in pairs and can be independent from one another. The configuration in FIG. **46B** can enhance the apposition between the electrodes **131** and the tissue of a vessel wall.

(252) FIG. **46C** illustrates that the stent **101** can have 14 electrodes **131** arranged as shown. Other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated. The electrodes **131** can be positioned in bipolar pairs. The stent **101** of FIG. **46C** is similar to the stent **101** of FIG. **46B**, except that the bipolar electrode pairs are constructed with one electrode mounted to an open cell and another electrode mounted in an open cell style to that electrode to enhance electrode apposition while ensuring known distance between electrodes.

(253) FIG. **46D** illustrates that the stent **101** can have 16 electrodes **131** arranged as shown. Other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated. The electrodes **131** can be positioned in bipolar pairs. FIG. **46D** illustrates that the stent **101** can have a straight, single strut bipolar pair open cell design. The electrodes **131** can be mounted on the inside of open cell struts with a bipolar pair electrode **131** attached with single linear strut **108**. This can reduce the amount of material required (compared, for example, to the amount of material required for the stent **101** illustrated in FIG. **46C**). The configuration in FIG. **46D** can enhance the apposition between the electrodes **131** and the tissue of a vessel wall.

(254) FIG. **46E** illustrates that the stent **101** can have 16 electrodes **131** arranged as shown. Other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated. The electrodes **131** can be positioned in bipolar pairs. The cells of the stent **101** can have the shapes shown. The electrodes can have the locations shown, although any location on struts **108** defining the cells is appreciated. The stent **101** can be flexible and require less material than the stents **101** illustrated in FIGS. **46A-46D**. The configuration in FIG. **46E** can enhance the apposition between the electrodes **131** and the tissue of a vessel wall. For example, the configuration in FIG. **46E** can appose the vessel wall around vascular chordae which maintaining superelasticity, at least partly to the large open cell design.

(255) FIG. **46F** illustrates that the stent **101** can have sixteen electrodes **131** arranged as shown. Other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated. The stent **101** of FIG. **46F** is similar to the stent **101** of FIG. **46A** except that the stent **101** of FIG. **46F** can have a greater length

and is illustrated with more electrodes **131**.

(256) FIGS. **47A-47F** illustrate variations of stents **101** having various electrode **131** configurations. The stents **101** of FIGS. **47A-47F** are similar to the stents **101** of FIGS. **46A-46F** except for the different cell configurations and electrode **131** locations. FIGS. **47A-47F** illustrate that the stents **101** can have strut crosslinks **109** that are offset from one another, for example, by offset angles **304**. The offset crosslinks **109** can advantageously allow the stents **101** to be compressed without having any stent overlap. This can, in turn, advantageously allow the stents **101** to be more easily expanded by preventing or otherwise reducing the risk of cells and/or electrodes **131** from becoming entangled or snagged with one another when the stents **101** are expanded. For purposes of illustration, the stents **101** in FIGS. **47A-47E** have been illustrated with linearly arranged struts **108**, forming various diamond- and rectilinear-shaped cells. However, the cells of the stents **101** can be shaped as shown in the lower left insets of FIGS. **47A-47F**, which are similar to the small cells of FIGS. **46A-46F** except for the offset angles **304** described above. The offset angle can be, for example, 101 degrees (e.g., 101.3 degrees), although other offset angles, more or less, are also appreciated (e.g., 80 degrees to 120 degrees, or narrower or wider ranges). (257) FIGS. **47A-47F** illustrate that the length to width ratio of the cells can be 7:5. The 7:5 ratio helps ensure that the stents **101** can compress and expand.

(258) FIGS. **47A-47F** illustrate that the stents **101** can have a fork angle **302**. FIG. **47A** shows that the stents **101** can have a first fork angle **302F** and a second fork angle **302S**.

(259) The first and second fork angles **302F**, **302S** can be the same or different from one another. As shown, the first and second fork angles **302F**, **302S** can be measured, for example, between a center axis and first and second struts (not separately labeled) that extend from the connection panel **224**. The first and second fork angles **302F**, **302S** can each be from about 30 degrees to about 50 degrees. For example, the first fork angle **302F** can be about 41.5 degrees and the second fork angle **302S** can be about 35.5 degrees. Other fork angles, more or less, as well as other fork angle ranges, narrower or wider, are also appreciated. The fork angle **302** can advantageously allow for easier deployment (e.g., expansion) and retraction (e.g., compression) of the stents **101**.

(260) FIG. **47B** illustrates that the stent **101** can have sixteen electrodes **131** arranged as shown. Other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated. The sixteen electrodes can be arranged in a ladder style having two or more “rungs.” For example, the sixteen electrodes can be arranged in five rungs of electrodes **131** having a 2-4-4-5-1 pattern. The stent **101** can have any number of rungs and any number of electrodes **131** in each of the rungs, including four rungs having a 2-4-5-5 electrode pattern. As another example, FIG. **47C** illustrates that the stent **101** can have sixteen electrodes arranged in five ladder rungs having a 1-3-3-4-5 electrode pattern. The 1-3-3-4-5 pattern of FIG. **47C** can advantageously provide additional electrical evaluation length (e.g., stimulation and/or recording length) relative to shorter ladder configurations, for example, the 2-4-5-5 pattern of FIG. **47B**. The ladder style can advantageously assist with delivery through vascular tortuosity and enable navigation of vascular chordae whilst ensuring electrode apposition and self-expansion.

(261) FIG. **47D** illustrates that the stent **101** can have ten electrodes **131** arranged as shown. The ten electrodes **131** are shown in a 1-2-2-2-3 five rung ladder pattern, although any ladder pattern having ten electrodes is appreciated. The stent **101** can have relative cell sizes similar to the large and small cells described above with reference to FIG. **46A**.

(262) FIG. **47E** illustrates that the stent **101** can have sixteen electrodes **131** arranged as shown. FIG. **47E** illustrates that the stent **101** can have larger cells on the border (e.g., perimeter) of the stent **101** and more dense cells closer to the center (e.g., in the center) of the stent **101**. This arrangement of cells and electrodes **131** can advantageously provide an enhanced region for recording or stimulation closer to the center of the stent **101**. As shown, the electrodes **131** can be arranged in an eight rung 1-2-3-2-3-2-1-2 ladder pattern, although any ladder pattern having sixteen electrodes **131** is appreciated.

(263) FIG. 47F illustrates that the stent **101** can have sixteen electrodes arranged in seven ladder rungs having a 2-1-4-2-2-3-2 electrode pattern. The 2-1-4-2-2-3-2 pattern of FIG. 47F can advantageously provide additional electrical evaluation length (e.g., stimulation and/or recording length) relative to shorter ladder configurations, for example, relative to the ladder patterns of FIG. 47B-47D. FIG. 47F illustrates fork angles **302F**, **302S** that assist with delivery, retraction and deployment, skewed electrode locations for improved deliverability and reducing overlap, interleaved cells for overlap and radial force, cell aspect ratio for deliverability and self-expansion. (264) For purposes of illustration, the stents **101** in FIGS. 46A-47F described above and FIGS. 48A-48B, 46B-46C, 51B, 52B, 53B-53C, 54A-57 and 58C described below are shown flat so that the cells, struts **108**, electrodes **131**, and/or electrode tracks **236** can be easily seen. However, the stents **101** are curved in practice (e.g., when in the compressed and/or expanded configuration). The top of the stents **101** can be directly joined to the bottom of the stents **101** (the top and bottom as shown in FIGS. 46A-47F) to form cylindrical tube-like stent structures that can exert radial outward forces against a vessel wall. The top of the stents **101** can curve around to meet (with or without permanent attachment) the bottom of the stents **101**. A portion of the top and bottom of the stents **101** can overlap or there can be a gap therebetween.

(265) FIGS. 48A-48D illustrate a variation of a stent **101**. FIG. 48A illustrates that the stent **101** can have eight electrodes **131** arranged as shown. The stent **101** can have a proximal end **250** and a distal end **260**. The proximal end **250** can include a second panel **224** as described above. The second panel **224** can have stent pads **238**. FIG. 48B illustrates the struts **108** of FIG. 48A that have electrode tracks **236**. For purposes of illustration, the stent **101** is shown flat in FIGS. 48A and 48B but can be curved as described above. FIG. 48C is a magnified view of the proximal end **250** of the stent **101** of FIG. 48A at section 48C-48C and shows the electrode tracks **236** electrically connected to the stent pads **238**. An overlay **222** can be placed over the stent pads **238**. FIG. 48D is a magnified view of an electrode **131** of FIG. 48A at section 48D-48D.

(266) FIGS. 49A-49C illustrate a variation of a stent **101** having seven electrodes **131** arranged as shown. The stent **101** of FIGS. 49A-49C is similar to the stent **101** of FIG. 46A. FIG. 49A illustrates a perspective view of the stent **101** having a curved profile in an expanded configuration. FIG. 49B illustrates the stent **101** in a flat configuration. FIG. 49C illustrates the struts **108** of FIGS. 49A and 49B that have the electrode tracks **236**. FIGS. 49B and 49C illustrate that the struts **108** can get thicker from the distal end **260** to the proximal end **250**, for example, to accommodate multiple electrode tracks **236** as they merge into a common strut and/or to increase the axial and radial forces/resilience of the stent **101**. Multiple electrode tracks **236** on a common strut can be parallel to each other.

(267) FIGS. 50A-50C illustrate front perspective, rear perspective and top views of a variation of a stent **101** connected to a connection panel **220**. The stent **101** can have eight electrodes **131** arranged as shown.

(268) FIGS. 51A and 51B illustrate a variation of a stent **101** having eight electrodes **131** arranged as shown. FIG. 51A illustrates a perspective view of the stent **101** having a curved profile in an expanded configuration and FIG. 51B illustrates the stent **101** in a flat configuration. The stent **101** can have a reinforced section **62**. As shown, the electrode tracks **236** from each of the electrodes **131** can merge into the reinforced section **62**. The multiple electrode tracks **236** in the reinforced section **62** can be parallel to each other. Some of the struts **108** and/or the reinforced section **62** can get thicker from the distal end **260** to the proximal end **250**. The stent pads **238** can be directly connected to the lead wires **141** of a connector **200** (not shown). The stent pads **238** can be indirectly connected to the lead wires **141** of a connector **200** (not shown).

(269) FIGS. 52A-52C illustrate a variation of a stent **101** having sixteen electrodes **131** arranged as shown. The proximal end **250** can include a second panel **224** as described above. The second panel **224** can have stent pads **238**. FIG. 52A illustrates a perspective view of the stent **101** having a curved profile in an expanded configuration and FIG. 52B illustrates the stent **101** in a flat

configuration. The stent **101** can have a reinforced section **62**. FIG. 52B illustrates that some of the electrode tracks **236** can merge into a top, bottom, or middle strut **108**, or any other strut. The middle strut **108** can be the reinforced section **62**. Some of the struts **108** and/or the reinforced section **62** can get thicker from the distal end **260** to the proximal end **250**. FIG. 52C is a magnified view of the proximal end **250** of the stent **101** of FIGS. 52A and 52B and shows the electrode tracks **236** electrically connected to the stent pads **238**. An overlay **222** can be placed over the stent pads **238**. The stent pads **238** can be directly connected to the lead wires **141** of a connector **200** (not shown). The stent pads **238** can be indirectly connected to the lead wires **141** of a connector **200** (not shown).

(270) FIGS. 53A-53D illustrate a variation of a stent **101** having sixteen electrodes **131** arranged as shown. FIG. 53A illustrates a perspective view of the stent **101** having a curved profile in an expanded configuration. FIG. 53B illustrates the stent **101** in a flat configuration. FIG. 53C illustrates the struts **108** of FIGS. 53A and 53B that have electrode tracks **236**. FIG. 53C illustrates that some of the electrode tracks **236** can merge into a top strut and some of the electrode tracks **236** can merge into a bottom strut. FIG. 53D is a magnified view of the proximal end **250** of the stent **101** of FIGS. 52A and 52B and shows the electrode tracks **236** electrically connected to the stent pads **238**.

(271) FIGS. 54A and 54B illustrate a variation of a stent **101**. FIG. 54A illustrates that the stent **101** can have eight electrodes **131** arranged as shown. Other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated. FIG. 54B illustrates the struts **108** of FIG. 54A that have electrode tracks **236**. FIG. 54B illustrates that some of the electrode tracks **236** can merge into a top strut and some of the electrode tracks **236** can merge into a bottom strut.

(272) FIGS. 55A and 55B illustrate a variation of a stent **101**. The stent **101** of FIGS. 55A and 55B is similar to the stent **101** of FIGS. 54A and 54B except that the cells in FIG. 55A have a uniform size.

(273) FIGS. 56A-56D illustrate various variations of stents **101** without electrode tracks. The stents **101** can have electrodes **131** arranged as shown. Other numbers of electrodes, more or less, are also appreciated. FIG. 56C illustrates that the struts **108** can have first, second, third and fourth portions **108i**, **108ii**, **108iii**, and **108iv**, respectively, where the thickness of the strut first portion **108i** is greater than the strut second portion **108ii**, where the thickness of the strut second portion **108ii** is greater than the strut third portion **108iii**, where the thickness of the strut third portion **108iii** is greater than the strut fourth portion **108iv**, or any combination thereof where the strut **108** has more or less portions. For example, the first, second third and fourth portions **108i**, **108ii**, **108iii** and **108iv** can have thicknesses, for example, of about 0.33 mm, about 0.29 mm, about 0.21 mm, about 0.13 mm, respectively.

(274) FIG. 57 illustrates a variation of a lattice structure for a stent **101**.

(275) FIGS. 58A-58C illustrate a variation of a stent **101** having sixteen electrodes **131** arranged as shown. The stent **101** of FIGS. 58A-58C is similar to the stent **101** of FIG. 47F. FIGS. 58A and 58B illustrate perspective and side views of the stent **101** having a curved profile in an expanded configuration. The curved profile can have a gap **240**. FIG. 58C illustrates the stent **101** in a flat configuration. The stent **101** can have the various dimensions shown (in millimeters) in FIG. 58C.

(276) Any of the stents **101** disclosed and/or contemplated herein can be wireless stents (also referred to as wireless electrode systems). The stents **101** can have one or more wireless transmitters (e.g., the wireless transmitter **1002** of FIG. 31). The wireless transmitters can be attached to or integrated with the stents **101**. The wireless transmitters can be a separate device and/or can be an arrangement of one or more electrodes **131** of the stents **101**. For example, an arrangement of one or more electrodes **131** can form a wireless antenna that can send and/or receive information. The electrodes **131** can record or pick up neural information and relay this information to a wireless transmitter. This recorded information can be wirelessly transmitted through the skull to a wireless receiver (e.g., the wireless receiver **1004** of FIG. 31). The wireless

receiver can decode and transmit the acquired neural information to a device such as a prosthetic limb or a visual prosthesis.

(277) The wireless stents (e.g. stents **101**) can be configured for the transmission of both power and data. Power can be wirelessly transmitted to the wireless stents to operate the circuitry of the stents and data can be wireless transmitted from the wireless stents to, for example, a control unit (e.g., control unit **12**). In addition to or in lieu of the wireless power, the stents can be powered with a piezoelectric energy power generator that generates energy from blood flow and/or from vascular constriction and dilation.

(278) The wireless stent systems can be fully or partly wireless. Fully wireless means that no portion of the stent (e.g., stents **101**), including the electrodes **131** and wireless circuitry, extends beyond a vessel wall after implantation. Semi-wireless means that at least a portion of the stent (e.g., stents **101**), electrodes **131** and/or wireless circuitry extends beyond a vessel wall after implantation. The stent **101** of FIG. **31** is an example of a fully wireless stent system. As shown in FIG. **31**, the entire device (stent and electronics) can be within the blood vessel, or otherwise become embedded within the blood vessel over time. The stent **101** of FIG. **2A** is an example of a semi-wireless system, where the wireless electronics sit outside the vessel in the pectoral region. The system of FIG. **2A** is similar to, for example, a pacemaker where the wireless system sits outside of the vessel. Semi wireless systems can have a wire that passes from within a blood vessel to outside a blood vessel.

(279) As described above, the stents **101** can be used to scaffold the electrodes **131** against the vessel wall. Wireless stent systems can have one or more stents (e.g., stents **101**), for example, between one and ten stents (e.g., 1, 2, or 3 or more stents **101**). Other numbers of stents, more or less, as well as ranges, narrower or wider, are also appreciated. If the wireless electronics cannot be mounted on or integrated with a first stent **101** having electrodes **131** (e.g., due to space or functional requirements), the wireless electronics can be mounted or integrated with a second stent **101** (e.g., which can have the same or a different number of electrodes than the first stent **101**, or no electrodes). Such multi-stent systems (e.g., dual-stent systems) can advantageously carry the circuitry away from the center of the vessel where it has a chance of causing occlusion or blockage. The first and second stents of a dual-stent system can advantageously form a dipole antenna, which can improve wireless transmission of the system. The second stent can be under the skull connected directly (but not electrically) to the first stent, or can be placed in the neck, tethered to the first stent. Other arrangements are also appreciated (e.g., the first and second stents can be electrically connected to one another). A benefit of placing the second stent in the neck includes a reduction in distance to the body surface. Placement in the neck is also expected to cause less interference to the acquisition and amplification of the neural signals.

(280) The system (e.g., system **10**) can have one or more stents **101** in wired and/or wireless communication with a telemetry unit (e.g., control unit **12**). For example, the system can be an endovascular telemetry and closed loop cortical recording and/or stimulation system for the diagnosis, prediction and treatment of epilepsy. Endovascular telemetry systems for epilepsy (also referred to as epilepsy care systems) can advantageously record brain activity 24 hours/day 7 days/week. This 24/7 monitoring offers a critical advantage to doctors and patients alike, as traditionally the ability of the treating physician to determine the number of seizures a patient is suffering depends on the patient recording a seizure diary, which can be, and are notoriously, inaccurate. Knowing how many and the nature of seizures occurring in a patient can be critical in determining the correct dosing for anti-seizure treatment by the physician, which the endovascular telemetry system provides. The epilepsy care systems can receive inputs that can modulate treatment doses of medications/drugs.

(281) For recording telemetry, a stent **101** can be implanted in cortical venous targets (including the transverse sinus) to achieve proximity to cortical regions of interest for seizure detection (including the temporal lobe). The stent **101** can be or can be part of an implantable telemetry unit (ITU). The

ITU can house a data unit that can collect brain recordings 24/7. The ITU can be accessed wirelessly by the user or physician to review the neural information over a time period of interest. The ITU can be accessed wirelessly for real-time assessment of the neural information. For example, in periods of higher-risk (including when the patient is unwell, or having to make modifications to their treatment regimen) the physician is able to assess neural signal in real time. The neural data collected by the ITU can be streamed into a range of apps that allow various real time functions. For example, the neural data collected can be communicated to third party applications that apply software analysis of the neural data (including for seizure prediction). In this way, the collected data can be made available to third party users to generate information or modulation information to the patients upon use of the collected data. The epilepsy care systems can have closed loop feedback. For example, the collected data can be utilized in an input loop into a treatment-delivery system to enable precise dosage determinations based upon data containing real-time seizure detection (including vagal nerve stimulator, drug delivery systems). The epilepsy care systems can perform neuromodulation. For example, responsive neural stimulation can be achieved by the endovascular systems described herein having stents **101**. This can advantageously enable a closed loop system by utilizing the stent system to record and deliver treatment by stimulating across the vessel wall (e.g., from one or more electrodes **131** of one or more stents **101**) to achieve seizure termination.

(282) FIGS. **59A-59C** illustrate a telemetry unit lead **400** having a snake and rung design connected to a telemetry device **12**. The snake and rung design can advantageously reduce the surgical manipulation required to shorten the lead **400**, for example, if the lead is too long. Typically, leads are shortened by winding the lead on itself; however, such winding can cause fatigue as the lead rubs on itself and wears away and/or can require a larger incision into muscles during surgery. The snake and rung design prevents/avoids these risks. As shown in FIGS. **59A-59C**, the telemetry unit lead **400** can be a set overall size (e.g., overall length) that is curled into a snake form **404** connected by one or more rungs **402**. The rungs **402** can be made of silicone or other biocompatible material that has some flex. If a longer lead is required, one or more of the rungs **402** can be detached (e.g., through surgical cutting or otherwise) so that the lead length can be increased. In this way, the length of a generic telemetry unit lead **400** can be tailored/customized to a patient and to the surgical placement of the telemetry device **12** during surgery. For example, FIGS. **59A-59C** illustrate that the lead length can be increased from L.sub.1 to L.sub.2 by detaching four rungs **402**, for example, during surgery. One or more rungs **402** (e.g., one, two, or three or more) can be placed centrally or on the left and/or right edges of the snaked portion **404** of lead **400**, or somewhere in between.

(283) As described above, the telemetry unit (e.g., control unit **12**) can communicate information (using wires or wirelessly) to and/or from an external apparatus **16**, which can include (but is not limited to) one or more of the following: (a) an exoskeleton; (b) wheelchair; (c) computer; and/or (d) other electrical or electro-mechanical device.

(284) For example, FIGS. **60a-60d** illustrate a variation of a system **10** having a stent **101** implanted in the vascular of a person's brain, for example, a vessel traversing the person's superior sagittal sinus. FIG. **60a** illustrates the system **10** and FIGS. **60b-60c** illustrate three magnified views of the system **10** as shown. The stent **101** can be implanted for example, via the jugular vein, into the superior sagittal sinus (SSS) overlying the primary motor cortex to passively record brain signals and/or stimulate tissue. The stent **101** can record and interpret brain signals that are associated with intentions to move, so that people who are paralyzed due to neurological injury or disease, can communicate, improve mobility and potentially achieve independent through direct brain control of assistive technologies such as computer software and/or apparatuses **16** (e.g., robotic upper limb prostheses, motorized wheelchairs, and the like). Other applications for the stent **101** as described throughout this disclosure are also appreciated.

(285) The system **10** can have one or multiple telemetry units. The system **10** can have one or

multiple internal and/or external telemetry units. FIGS. **60a** and **60d** illustrate that the system can have an internal telemetry unit (e.g., control unit **12**) in wired or wireless communication with an external telemetry unit **15**. For example, the external telemetry unit **15** can be wirelessly connected to the internal telemetry unit **12** across the user's skin. The internal telemetry unit **12** can be in wireless or wired communication with the stent **101**. For example, FIGS. **60a-60d** illustrate that the stent **101** can be electrically connected to the internal control unit **12** via a communication conduit **14**. The communication conduit **14** can be a stent lead. As shown in FIG. **60c**, the stent lead can extend from the stent **101**, pass through a wall of the jugular, and tunnel under the skin to a subclavian pocket. In this way, the communication conduit **14** can facilitate communications between the stent **101** and the internal control unit **12**.

(286) As shown in FIGS. **60a-60d** (as well as FIGS. **1-2B**), the one or multiple telemetry units can be located/implanted in and/or on the chest of a user. However, the telemetry unit can be located in any suitable location. For example, the telemetry unit can be located/implanted behind the ear of a user. For example, one or multiple telemetry units can be located/implanted behind the ear of the user at, or otherwise proximate to, location **19** shown in FIG. **60a**. Relative to placement in and/or on the chest, positioning the control unit behind a user's ear can advantageously reduce artifacts and noise due to neck and muscle movement, for example, because the communication conduit **14** (e.g., stent lead) would not need to be located in the neck of a user.

(287) The internal telemetry unit **12** can be connected to one or multiple external apparatuses **16**. The internal telemetry unit **12** can be connected to one or multiple internal apparatuses (not shown), for example, visual prosthetics and other controllable devices implanted partially or completely within or on a person's body. The external telemetry unit **15** can be connected to one or multiple external apparatuses **16**. The external telemetry unit **15** can be connected to one or multiple internal apparatuses (not shown), for example, visual prosthetics and other controllable devices implanted partially or completely within or on a person's body.

(288) As described above, the system (e.g., system **10**) can have one or more stents **101**. The stents **101** can be in wired and/or wireless communication with a telemetry unit (e.g., control unit **12**). The stents **101** can record and or stimulate areas of the cortex associated with vision. For example, the system can be an endovascular visual prosthesis neural interface having one or more stents **101**. The stent **101** can be used to access deep, folded areas of cortex in the occipital lobe (e.g., the primary visual cortex) that are not reachable via open brain surgery, and which cannot be targeted by current technology (i.e., technology that is implanted directly onto the cortical surface of the occipital lobe). FIG. **34** shows a method for stimulation and the recording neural information or the stimulation of neurons from the visual cortex of a patient using the device **100**, including the steps of: (a) implanting the device in a vessel in the visual cortex of the patient; and (b) recording neural information associated with the vessel or stimulating neurons in accordance with received stimulation data. The stents **101** can be implanted in the superior sagittal sinus and/or the transverse sinus to advantageously achieve transvascular stimulation of the occipital region of interest, although any implant location is appreciated. Information from the visual world can be captured in a video capture. The information can be translated into a stimulation algorithm. The translated information can be delivered into the occipital lobe via stimulation via one or more stents **101**. The visual prosthetic system can contain a large number of electrodes embedded into the wall of the transverse and superior sagittal sinus via the one or more stents **101**.

(289) The one or more stents **101** can be used for an endovascular neural interface system for deep brain stimulation treatment. Current deep brain stimulation requires a craniotomy for implantation of the leads. Craniotomy procedures are associated with myriad complications and risks including hemorrhage. The stents **101** can eliminate the need for craniotomies. The stents **101** can access to deep structures suitable as targets for deep brain stimulation is viable through deep venous and arterial vessels in the brain. A catheter can be used to access the deep blood vessels. The stents **101** can enable stimulation of targeted brain tissue. Implantation of an endovascular lead into a deep

structure can enable stimulation of the brain tissue. The stents **101** and systems disclosed herein can treat a range of conditions with deep brain stimulation, including Parkinson's disease, dystonia, obsessive compulsive disorder, depression, among others. Many modifications will be apparent to those skilled in the art without departing from the scope of the present invention.

(290) Electrode Array Nerve Cuff

(291) Another variation of the electrode systems disclosed and contemplated herein includes nerve cuff electrode systems. Additionally or alternatively, the systems described and contemplated herein can also function as nerve cuff electrode systems. For example, for nerve cuff electrode systems, the electrodes of the stents **101** can be on the internal side of the stent such that they are configured to face toward the nerve or nerve bundle for the stimulation and/or recording of energy when the stents **101** are deployed to function in a nerve cuff capacity (e.g., one or all of the electrodes can face or be directed in the opposite direction as the direction shown in the above-described stent configurations). The nerve can be in the wall of a blood vessel anywhere in the body. The nerve can be unaffiliated with a blood vessel. In practice, nerve cuff electrodes can be used to record and/or stimulate accessible nerves directly, and can be used to stimulate nerves for movement restoration and tactile feedback, as well as stimulation of internal nerve bundles (e.g., vagus nerve) for gut and parasympathetic interactions and pain, and measurement of internal neurons to assess neuronal and organ health. Nerves can be exposed and the cuff electrodes can be wrapped around them. Existing nerve cuff electrodes are difficult to attach and secure, and require buckle or attachment systems to strap the electrodes around the nerve. These buckle and attachment systems induce artifacts when the cuff electrodes move and can produce unreliable signals (e.g., when recording) or loss of current and subsequent sub-threshold activation when stimulating. Advantageously, the stents **101** do not require buckles or separate attachment systems, but can include them.

(292) The nerve cuff electrode arrays can be stent electrode arrays (e.g., stents **101** having the electrodes pointed in the opposite direction, for example, toward a center axis of the stents). The nerve cuff stents **101** can be biased to deploy partially or entirely around one or multiple nerves. For example, the nerve cuff stents **101** can be biased to collapse or self-collapse around a nerve or nerve bundle. FIGS. **61A** and **61B** illustrate a variation of a method of implanting a nerve cuff electrode array **101** having electrodes (e.g., electrodes **131** and/or **138**). FIG. **61A** illustrates that the stent **101** can be positioned over a nerve and/or vessel **502** in an open (e.g., flattened) configuration. Once the stent **101** is in the desired location, FIG. **61B** illustrates that the stent **101** can be allowed to compress and curl over (e.g., partially or completely around) the nerve and/or vessel **502**. The electrodes can be energized to activate the nerve. Using a self-collapsing stent (e.g., stent **101**) as a nerve cuff advantageously improves the ability to have a larger number of electrodes as part of the nerve cuff and allows for the removal of manual buckles or straps to maintain position. The nerve cuffs **101** can be manufactured with thin-film technology, so can have very accurate electrode sizes and locations. The electrodes can be attached to, integrated with, or built on miniature shafts or spikes so that the electrodes on the inside of the stent have a pillar or pyramidal shape and can be pressed into the nerve directly to access and record or stimulate fibres that are located centrally to the nerve bundle. This gives increased ease of implantation, increased reliability and manufacturing repeatability and enhanced performance and ability of the electrode to access and interact with surface and deeper nerve fibres. Additionally or alternatively, any of the stents and stent-like structures described herein can have electrodes on the inside and the outside of the device.

(293) Electrode Wires/Tracks

(294) The electrode lead wires can be made using thin film technology, which can advantageously reduce the thickness of the electrical pathways in the blood vessels or other locations in the body. The electrical pathways can be wires, conductive tracks (e.g., manufactured using thin film technology), or both. The electrical pathways can be implanted in the lumen of blood vessels, in the

wall of blood vessels, outside of blood vessels, or any combination thereof. Conductive tracks leading to and from the electrodes can desirably take up less space than wires by virtue of having a smaller cross-sectional size than wires. Since blood vessel lumens have a finite size, decreasing the cross-sectional size of the lead wires (e.g., by using thin film electrode tracks) can increase the amount of the lumen space that is available for blood flow as compared to when conventional wires are used. Using conductive electrode tracks can desirably result in thinner electrical pathways to and from any of the electrode arrays described and contemplated herein (e.g., the stents **101**), for example, as compared to wires. Also, although electrode lead wires and electrode thin film tracks each have disadvantages, this disclosure is not teaching against implementing either, as each technique, alone or in combination with the other, can be used to directly or indirectly connect the electrodes of the arrays disclosed herein to a controller, whether that controller is positioned in the brain, neck, chest, or elsewhere in or on the body, or on the stent itself. For example, when wires are used, each electrode wire has a thickness, and this thickness can limit the number of electrode wires that can be implanted within a vessel of set diameter. This can be effectively managed by choosing the appropriate number and size of wires and/or by using electrode tracks in addition to wires. As another example, when electrode tracks are used, the tracks can have an increased electrical resistance, fragility, risk of breakage, and fatigue as compared to conventional wires. However, this can be successfully managed by choosing the appropriate thickness and number of electrode tracks and/or by using wires in addition to the use of non-wire electrode tracks.

(295) Additionally or alternatively, the electrode wires and/or tracks can be arranged in a coil that defines an internal lumen where the internal lumen can allow fluid (e.g., blood) to flow through. The coil can have a spiral arrangement such as a helix. The coil lumen can be smaller than, larger than, or approximately the same size as the blood vessel lumen. The coil can have one or multiple lumens. An axial center of the coil lumen can align with or be offset from the blood vessel lumen. The coil can be attached to, integrated with, absorbed into the blood vessel wall, or any combination thereof. The coil can be coated with bioabsorbable coating. The coil can have anchors configured to attach to and/or extend through the vessel wall.

(296) Having a coil of wires and/or electrode tracks can desirably reduce the amount of space needed for the electrical pathways inside the vessel, leaving more of the blood vessel lumen available for blood flow or other devices (e.g., blood pressure sensors). The coil of electrical pathways can thereby block less of the vessel lumens as compared to conventional techniques. For example, a large coiled wire bundle with a central lumen that allows for the passage of blood can be implanted. This cable, like the stents **101**, can be incorporated into the vessel wall. By using thin film technology, these cables can be made very thin, although generic ribbon cables (or bunched wires) can also be shape set to the dimensions of the vessel to allow for both deployment and incorporation. The cables can be custom shape set to match a person's unique vessel tortuosity. The method by which the cable is coiled can ensure the force is sufficient to push the device for deployment (which can be but need not be included for a device with a magnetic tip), whilst also allowing the coils to be compressed in smaller diameter regions of vessel. During deployment, the coil can have a constant diameter or can have multiple diameters across the length of the coil, for example, depending on the external environment, the vessel tortuosity, the vessel size, the vessel lumen size, or any combination of these factors. After implantation, the coil can have a constant diameter or can have multiple diameters across the length of the coil, for example, depending on the external environment, the vessel tortuosity, the vessel size, the vessel lumen size, or any combination of these factors.

(297) Electrode Track Arrangement

(298) The struts **108** of the stentroids (e.g., stents **101**) disclosed and contemplated herein can carry the electrical tracks to and from the electrodes. The number of tracks (and hence number of electrodes) can be increased by having multiple layers of conductive material. However, with each increase in conductor, there also needs to be an increase in insulation (and thicker insulation to

prevent electrical crosstalk and capacitive interference). As another example, the number of tracks can be increased by decreasing the track thickness to have more tracks per strut. Each strut can have one or multiple electrode tracks. Each strut can have one or multiple layers of conductive material. Additionally or alternatively, the number of tracks can be increased by overlaying multiple thin film electrodes on top of each other. This can allow the separate thin film designs to retain the thick electrode tracks required for durability and electrical resistance reduction, and also allows for many more electrodes to be implanted. In this way, multiple thin film conductive pathways can be overlaid to form layered pathways, layered electrodes, or both. Such overlaid designs can desirably overcome the issue faced with current limitations of printing multiple track layers, and can also ensure that each individual stent is thin, assisting with incorporation and also assisting with flexibility (e.g., two of set thickness can be more flexible than one of double thickness).

(299) Stent Length

(300) The entire device or the part implanted within the blood vessel can be a stent (e.g., stents **101**), for example, a tubular stent. In such variations, the cable can be removed from the device but need not be. The electrode tracks can traverse on or through the struts the entire length of the stent **101**. The stents **101** can have a length from about 5 mm to about 750 mm or more, including every 1 mm increment within this range (e.g., 5 mm, 30 mm, 100 mm, 200 mm, 300 mm, 400 mm, 500 mm, 600 mm, 700 mm) and every 10 mm range within this range (e.g., 5 mm-15 mm, 30 mm-40 mm, 100 mm-110 mm, 200 mm-210 mm, 300 mm-310 mm, 400 mm-410 mm, 500 mm-510 mm, 600 mm-610 mm, 700 mm-710 mm). The stent can be implanted in one or multiple blood vessels. When implanted, the stent can be implanted at a junction between a first blood vessel and a second blood vessel and in one or both of the first and second blood vessels. The stent can have a length such that a first portion is in the brain, a second portion is in the neck, a third portion is in the body below the neck (e.g., chest), or any combination thereof. One or more sections of the stent can be energized or record signals independently from one or more other sections of the stent. The stent length can refer to the length of the stent when the stent is in an unexpanded configuration, a partially expanded configuration, or a fully expanded configuration. The stent **101** can be made in one or multiple pieces. For example, the stent **101** can be made from a single wafer. Stents **101** having long lengths can have the ability to be implanted in one or multiple vessels, for example, from the same entry point. Stents **101** having long lengths can desirably remove the errors between connections, for example, with a stent lead.

(301) Stents **101** without lead wires and cables can be used. For example, long stents **101** can eliminate the need for lead wires and cables. Removing the cable can advantageously reduce this risk of vascular blockage by reducing or eliminating eddy currents that can form at the transition between the stent (e.g., incorporated into the vessel wall) and the cable (e.g., positioned and incorporated into one side of the vessel wall) since eddy currents can contribute to the formation of thrombus or occlusion. Removing the cable can also desirably eliminate the electrical connection needed between the tracks and the cable, which can have a risk of fatigue, and thereby improve the connection reliability, connection diameter and geometry and lead incorporation.

(302) Stent and Cable Connection

(303) The electrodes mounted or embedded within the stents **101** can be connected to a cable to relay the information recorded by the electrodes (e.g., in the brain) to equipment or connectors outside the blood vessel and body. The electrode tracks and the cable can be connected in various ways.

(304) For example, FIG. 62A illustrates a variation of a connection in which bump bonds **229** can connect the electrode pads **238** on the stent **101** to the lead wires **141** directly. The lead wires **141** can pass through the openings **228** (also referred to as through holes) in the connection panel **220**. Additionally or alternatively, the wires **141** in FIG. 62A can be feedthroughs ultimately connected to the wires **141** where bump bonding from the pads on the stent to feedthroughs on an interposer (e.g., connection panel **220**) are connected to wires **141** that form the lead or cable. The wires **141**

and feedthroughs can be flat. The wires **141** and feedthroughs can be made of soft materials that can be flattened during the process and connected to, for example, metals including platinum and aluminum oxide. The connections shown in FIG. **62A** can be included for stents having any length but are not required, for example, for stents having a long length (e.g., about 40 mm or greater). As another example, an intermediate can be used to allow MP35N (or other material) wires to be connected to small (e.g., 100×200 μm) pads. In this example, the pads can be gold (or otherwise) bump bonded to platinum wires, and the wires can then be crimped to the cables. As yet another example, an interposer can also be used to connect the cables to the pads. In this case, a replica of the pads is cut out of an insulating substance, and holes are drilled overlying the locations of the pads. These holes can be backfilled with conductive material, which can be attached (e.g., through laser welding, soldering or other methods) to the cables. Additionally or alternatively, the cables can be fed directly into the holes prior to filling. The filled holes can be ground and the interposer can then be flip-chip bonded to the stent pads. The flip-chip bonding can be conducted prior to the connection of the cables to increase the reliability of the robotically automated alignment.

(305) FIG. **62B** illustrates a variation of manufacturing stentrodes (e.g., stents **101**) that have long, comb-like fingers **225** for each of the contacts that allow for wire wrapping or other connection method to the pads **238** (which are also elongated) on the stent **101**. Each finger **225** can have one long contact, with more area to attach to. Wire wrapping can be performed around each of the fingers **225**, as they will be thin enough and separated such that they are flexible and can be attached to independently. The fingers **225** coming from the back of the stent fork **302** would allow for easier manipulation and can allow for cable wire wrapping to be used to connect the stent to the cable (e.g., to connect the stent **101** to the wires **141**). FIG. **62B** further illustrates that the separation **227** between adjacent fingers can be about 5 μm to about 50 μm, including every 5 μm increment within this range (e.g., 10 μm).

(306) FIG. **62C** illustrates a close-up of a finger **225**, showing that the finger **225** can include a track **225a** and contact **225b**. The track **225a** can be about a 50 μm track and can connect the fingers **225** to the stent pads (e.g., pads **238**). The contact **225b** can be, for example, 100 μm wide and 3 mm long, or as long as the length of the stent **10**.

(307) FIG. **62D** illustrates another variation to improve the connection between the stent **101** and the wires **141**. As shown, the electrode pads (e.g., pads **238**, pads **226**) can be set into grooves **233**, such that the wires **141** used to connect to the pads can be easily handled and attached. For example, the wires can be placed in the grooves and then welded, with the grooves used to position and hold the wires in place prior to bonding. FIG. **62D** illustrates 16 grooves and 16 corresponding pads, numbered from 1 to 16. However, any number is possible.

(308) FIG. **62E** illustrates a variation where the stent **101** is printed such that connection between the stent and the cable is not required. Here, the stent itself can form the basis of the cable. In one example, the stent could be printed with the same geometry, although much longer (ie, 10 cm-30 cm or long stents are envisioned as well. In another example, the stent scaffold can finish or terminate at the apex of the fork **302**, and only the electrode tracks can be printed the additional distance. Using 3D printing technology, these tracks can be printed as a helical cable around a mandrel smaller than that used for the stent (e.g., the stent **101** can be made using an 8 mm diameter mandrel, and the lead can be printed over a <1 mm diameter mandrel). In this way, the connection between the stent and the cable would not be required. As shown in FIG. **62E**, the stent end **235** proximal to the stent fork **302** can be increased without altering the stent lattice **101**, with the extended part **235** forming the lead (without the need to re-connect to a lead). In such variations, the lead can be thinner than the stent. The lead can be manufactured to enable connection and insertion into the stack. The stent **101** and the stent end **235** can be made in one or multiple pieces. For example, the stent **101** and the stent end **235** can be made from a single wafer. The stent end **235** can be flat, curve, or both. The stent end **235** can be a helical coil. The stent **101** and the stent end **235** can be monolithically formed or separately formed. For example, the device

shown in FIG. 62E can be a single long stent. The device shown in FIG. 62E has the ability to be implanted in one or multiple vessels, for example, from the same entry point. FIG. 62E further illustrates that the contacts 151 (e.g., rings) can be incorporated into this design, such that the entire manufacture of the stentode 101 is automated. Additionally or alternatively, the tracks can be exposed at the surface in different locations, with cylinders (e.g., platinum cylinders) weld to them directly.

(309) FIG. 62F illustrates a variation of the cross-section 62-62. As shown, the lead can be printed in 3D, with each electrode track woven around a central mandrel. This can give the lead flexibility and reliability. Multiple layers can be manufactured (e.g., 8 cables on the outer, 8 cables on the inner—same as the dual octofilar approach used for the lead described above in relation to FIGS. 41A-42).

(310) FIG. 62G illustrates another variation of the cross-section 62-62. As shown, the lead can be planar (2D) with wires next to each other or on top of each other, for example, pending manufacturing process.

(311) FIG. 62H illustrates that the stent 101 can have valleys 239 in the pads (e.g., pads 238, pads 226) such that the wires 141 can be laid in the valleys 239. The stent surface 101a can have stent valleys 101b. The pad valleys 239 can be in the stent valleys 101b. At the end of the valleys, the wires 141 can terminate, and can be welded to the pads that are in the valleys, beside the valleys, or both. For example, FIG. 62H illustrates a variation of a stent connection panel 220, showing two valleys (cut into the surface 101a of the stent 101) with two wires 141 laid into the valleys which assist in aligning the wires to either a contact pad within the valley or a contact pad on the stent surface next to the valley.

(312) More Stent Designs

(313) FIGS. 63A-63K illustrate variations of stents 101 having the lattice and electrode arrangements shown.

(314) FIG. 63A illustrates that the struts can have a strut thickness of about 30 μm to about 90 μm , including every 5 μm within this range (e.g., 50 μm , 70 μm). Increasing the width of the struts 108 from, for example, 50 μm to 70 μm can assist with alignment of the track layers 236 that are placed on top of the struts 108. A larger width will give a larger margin of error in placement of the platinum tracks, and consequently, there will be a significant reduction in tracks that are not printed on top of the struts (e.g., are printed with some of the track outside the borders of the nitinol struts which will result in shorts or broken tracks). As described above, the cell geometry and fork angle can be chosen specifically to accommodate the deployment of electrodes 131. FIG. 63A illustrates that all cells can be identical in shape (with the exception of the cells joining the fork) such that there is a known and consistent electrode separation.

(315) FIG. 63A further illustrates that the cell in the lower right of FIG. 47F can be removed, which is depicted by empty space 603 in FIG. 63A. This can desirably prevent the top right electrode 131 (e.g., in FIGS. 47F and 63A) from becoming entangled with this cell during deployment.

(316) FIG. 63B illustrates that the fork 302 can be defined by a first strut 108a, a second strut 108b, one or multiple third struts 108c, or any combination thereof. The first and second struts 108a, 108b can decrease in thickness distally away from the fork 302. The first and second struts 108a, 108b can increase in thickness proximally toward the fork 302, for example, to accommodate more electrode tracks. The first and second struts can be outer struts and the one or multiple third struts 108c can be inner struts. FIG. 63B illustrates that the fork 302 can have an inner fork and an outer fork. For example, the two third struts 108c can define the inner fork and the outer struts 108a and 108b can define the outer fork.

(317) FIG. 63B further illustrates that the struts 108c can have an increased length to increase the size (e.g., length) of the initial cell 602. This ensures that the length between the fork 302 and the first electrode 131 (or if this cell is removed as is the case in other designs, between the fork 302 and the initial cell junction) is of the same length. Having these lengths the same length helps

prevent a length mismatch when the stent is retracted. This can be desirable because such mismatches can cause excessive force on the strut junctions which can cause device damage or breakage.

(318) FIG. **63C** illustrates that the initial inner branches **108c** can each have a portion parallel or nearly parallel with the adjacent first or second outer branches **108a** and **108b**. For example, the branch angle **601** can be from about 1 degree to about 15 degrees, including every 1 degree increment within this range. The branches **108c** come off close to parallel (rather than a less parallel angle, for example, shown in FIGS. **46A-46F**) which enables the stent scaffold to collapse (and when it collapses during retraction into the catheter, these struts are now aligned with the catheter not at a larger angle to the catheter).

(319) FIGS. **63D** and **63E** illustrate the increase in length referred to in relation to FIG. **63A**, for example, in comparison to the stent **101** of FIG. **47F**. For example, FIGS. **63D** and **63E** illustrate that increasing the length of the initial struts **108c.sub.i** to the lengths of initial struts **108c.sub.ii** matches the distance from point A to point B of strut T1 compared with strut R1, and matches the distance from point A to point C comparing strut T2 with strut R2. The struts T1, T2, R1, R2, R3 can have lengths of about 9.51 mm, 13.82 mm, 8.82 mm, 3.29 mm and 9.65 mm, respectively.

(320) FIG. **63D** further illustrates that first and second struts **108a**, **108b** can increase in thickness proximally toward the fork **302**, for example, to accommodate more electrode tracks **236**. For example, the strut **108a** can have first, second and third strut regions having 8, 7 and 6 electrode tracks **236**, respectively. FIG. **63D** further illustrates that the strut **108d** can have the electrode track **236a**, that the electrode track **236a** can meander around the electrode **131**, and that the strut **108e** can have the electrode tracks **236a** and **236b**.

(321) FIG. **63F** illustrates that the struts **108e** illustrated in FIG. **63D** can be removed from the stent **101** (also compare to the stent **101** illustrated in FIG. **47F**). This can desirably prevent mismatch of lengths occurring. Removal of the struts **108e** does not detrimentally effect the deployment, retraction, or electrode and electrode track placement. In addition, the removal does not negatively impact the radial force of the stent, as while the electrodes need to be placed on the wall of the vessel, they do not need additional force to open up through plaques (e.g., as balloon expanding stents do) or need to catch and pull blood clots (e.g., as retrievers do), but may use additional force (e.g., as balloon expanding stents do) and may catch and pull blood clots (e.g., as retrievers do). The conductive paths **236** in these struts have been rerouted through the fork **302**.

(322) FIG. **63G** illustrates that the struts **108** that attach to electrodes can be attached to or integrated with the outside of the electrodes **131** (as opposed to joining at the centre as shown in FIGS. **47F** and **63A-63E**). This can significantly reduce the force at the junction, as there is less bending required for the struts **108** to be horizontal (e.g., parallel to the catheter when deployed). Consequently, this can desirably reduce the delivery force of the catheter.

(323) FIG. **63H** illustrates a close-up view of the struts **108** attached to an outer surface of the electrodes **131**.

(324) FIG. **63I** illustrates that all the connections on the stent **101** (e.g., both the electrode and non-electrode connections) can have a parallel section **604**. This can improve the junction between the struts **108** and between the struts and electrodes **108**, **131**, for example, by reducing the force on these links, and consequently reduce the force of the device during deployment and retraction. There can be a slightly larger curvature for each of the cells as the width and length (of the entire device) remains unchanged.

(325) FIG. **63J** illustrates that the stent of FIG. **63H** can have the fork **302** of FIG. **47F**.

(326) FIG. **63K** illustrates that the initial struts **108c** of FIGS. **63A-63I** can be reduced to a single strut **F1**. The strut **F1** can have a sinusoidal curve (e.g., can have an S-shape). This curve can hold electrode tracks. The length of strut **F1** can be chosen to match the length of the top and base fork struts **108a** and **108b**, as described previously. For example, strut **F1** can have a length of about 11.01 mm.

(327) For purposes of illustration, the stents **101** in FIGS. **63A-63K** described above and are shown flat so that the cells, struts **108**, electrodes **131**, and/or electrode tracks **236** can be easily seen. However, the stents **101** are curved in practice (e.g., when in the compressed and/or expanded configuration) as described above with the other figures.

(328) Any of the electrodes **131** described and illustrated can be electrodes **138**, and vice versa.

(329) Any of the wires **141** described and illustrated can be tracks **236**, and vice versa.

(330) All the dimensions in the drawings are exemplary.

(331) The scales shown in the drawings can be indicate relative dimensions without units, or can correspond to millimeters.

(332) The reference to any prior art in this specification is not, and should not be taken as, an acknowledgment or any form of suggestion that the prior art forms part of the common general knowledge in Australia

(333) In this specification and the claims that follow, unless stated otherwise, the word “comprise” and its variations, such as “comprises” and “comprising”, imply the inclusion of a stated integer, step, or group of integers or steps, but not the exclusion of any other integer or step or group of integers or steps.

(334) References in this specification to any prior publication, information derived from any said prior publication, or any known matter are not and should not be taken as an acknowledgement, admission or suggestion that said prior publication, or any information derived from this prior publication or known matter forms part of the common general knowledge in the field of endeavor to which the specification relates.

(335) Any elements described herein as singular can be pluralized (i.e., anything described as “one” can be more than one). Like reference numerals in the drawings indicate identical or functionally similar features/elements. Any species element of a genus element can have the characteristics or elements of any other species element of that genus. Some elements may be absent from individual figures for reasons of illustrative clarity. The above-described configurations, elements or complete assemblies and methods and their elements for carrying out the disclosure, and variations of aspects of the disclosure can be combined and modified with each other in any combination.

Claims

1. A method of transmitting neural activity of a patient, the method comprising: receiving a signal representative of neural activity from a support structure that maintains, carries, supports or incorporates one or more electrodes and is configured for navigation through a vessel into a brain of the patient, where the support structure comprises a first strut having a first conductive path and a second strut having a second conductive path, where the first conductive path is embedded in the first strut, where the second conductive path is embedded in the first strut and in the second strut, where the first conductive path and the second conductive path extend between a first end and a second end of the first strut, and where the first conductive path and the second conductive path are independent data channels, the method further comprising transmitting or receiving first data via the first conductive path and transmitting or receiving second data different from the first data via the second conductive path; generating data representing the neural activity using the signal; transmitting said data to a control unit; generating a control signal from the control unit; and transmitting the control signal to an apparatus coupled to the patient.
2. The method of claim 1, where the one or more electrodes are arranged around a circumference of the support structure, where the support structure has a contracted configuration and an expanded configuration, where when the support structure is in the contracted configuration, the first conductive path and the second conductive path are separated by a first distance, where when the support structure is in the expanded configuration, the first conductive path and the second conductive path are separated by a second distance, and where the second distance is greater than

the first distance.

3. The method of claim 1, where the first strut has a first embedded electrode where the first conductive path is exposed, and where the second strut has a second embedded electrode where the second conductive path is exposed.
4. The method of claim 3, where the first embedded electrode is located where the first strut intersects the second strut.
5. The method of claim 1, where the support structure is positioned in the vessel selected from either a vessel in a superior sagittal sinus or a branching cortical vein.
6. The method of claim 1, where the support structure is positioned in the vessel located adjacent to a visual cortex of a patient.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the vessel is located in a muscle for direct muscular stimulation or recording.
8. The method of claim 1, wherein the vessel adjacent to a peripheral nerve for stimulation or recording.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein the vessel is adjacent to a sympathetic or parasympathetic nerve.
10. The method of claim 1, where the signal travels from a first electrode through the first conductive path and through a lead coupled to the first conductive path to the control unit.
11. The method of claim 1, where at least one of the first strut or second strut has three embedded conductive paths.
12. A method of transmitting neural activity of a patient using a transvascular system, the method comprising: receiving a signal representative of neural activity from a support structure of the transvascular system, wherein the support structure maintains, carries, supports or incorporates one or more electrodes and is configured for navigation through a vessel into a brain of the patient, where the support structure comprises a first strut having a first conductive path and a second strut having a second conductive path, where the first conductive path is embedded in the first strut, where the second conductive path is embedded in the first strut and in the second strut, where the first conductive path and the second conductive path extend between a first end and a second end of the first strut, and where the first conductive path and the second conductive path are independent data channels, the method further comprising transmitting or receiving first data via the first conductive path and transmitting or receiving second data different from the first data via the second conductive path; generating data representing the neural activity using the signal; transmitting said data to a control unit; generating a control signal from the control unit; and transmitting the control signal to an apparatus coupled to the patient.
13. The method of claim 12, where the one or more electrodes are arranged around a circumference of the support structure, where the support structure has a contracted configuration and an expanded configuration, where when the support structure is in the contracted configuration, the first conductive path and the second conductive path are separated by a first distance, where when the support structure is in the expanded configuration, the first conductive path and the second conductive path are separated by a second distance, and where the second distance is greater than the first distance.
14. The method of claim 12, where the first strut has a first embedded electrode where the first conductive path is exposed, and where the second strut has a second embedded electrode where the second conductive path is exposed.
15. The method of claim 14, where the first embedded electrode is located where the first strut intersects the second strut.
16. The method of claim 12, where the support structure is positioned in a vessel selected from either a vessel in a superior sagittal sinus or a branching cortical vein.
17. The method of claim 12, wherein the vessel is located in a muscle for direct muscular stimulation or recording.
18. The method of claim 12, wherein the vessel adjacent to a peripheral nerve for stimulation or

recording.

19. The method of claim 12, wherein the vessel is adjacent to a sympathetic or parasympathetic nerve.

20. The method of claim 12, wherein the transvascular system comprises a coil that extends through a wall in the vessel.
